RealEstateManager

User Manual

Property, lease and accounting management — the complete operating guide

Properties & Units · Tenants & Contracts · PDC Management · Invoicing & VAT · Double-Entry Accounting · Financial Reporting · Tenant Self-Service

Applies to: the RealEstateManager web application

Audience: property administrators, leasing staff, accountants, system administrators

Edition: October 2026 · The same topics appear under the **Help** button on every screen

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About This System

RealEstateManager is a web-based system that manages a real-estate portfolio end to end: the **properties** you own or manage, the **units** inside them, the **tenants** who occupy them, the **lease contracts** that bind the two, and the **complete accounting** that results from all of it.

Its distinguishing characteristic is that operations and accounting are not two separate systems. Every operational action you take — signing a lease, receiving a cheque, issuing an invoice — produces a balanced double-entry journal automatically. You are never asked to write the accounting entry yourself, and the system refuses to save any journal whose debits do not equal its credits.

What the system covers

Area	What it does
Portfolio	Properties (owned or managed), units within each property, occupancy status, standard rents and areas.
Leasing	Tenant register, lease contracts with billing frequency and VAT, automatic generation of the full invoice schedule and the monthly revenue-recognition plan.
Collections	Post-dated cheque (PDC) register with memorandum and clearance postings, customer invoices and UAE tax invoices, customer receipts, security deposits.
Payables	Vendor register, multi-line vendor bills with VAT decided by the supplier's registration, vendor payments, petty cash floats.
Assets & deferrals	Fixed asset register with acquisition-cost accumulation, capitalisation and automatic depreciation schedules; recurring prepayment amortisation.
General ledger	Five-digit chart of accounts, account mapping, opening balances, manual journals, journal inquiry, monthly period close and fiscal year close.
Reporting	Trial Balance, Profit & Loss, Balance Sheet, Statement of Cash Flows, General Ledger, Tenant Statement, VAT Return, P&L by Property, Property Utilization, Tenant Health, Owner Tenancy Schedule, Owner Withdrawals.
Tenant self-service	A portal where tenants see their account and raise maintenance, payment-postponement and other requests, with a staff queue to answer them.
Administration	Multi-company support, per-user permissions with centralised master data, subscription control, audit logging, user feedback.

Two ownership models

Every property is flagged as either **Owned** or **Managed**, and this single flag changes the accounting for every lease under it:

- **Owned** — the rent is your revenue. Invoiced rent sits in *Advances from Customers* and is released monthly into *Rental Revenue – Owned*.

- **Managed** — the rent belongs to the landlord. Invoiced rent sits in *Due to Landlords*, and only your commission is released into *Management Fee Revenue*.

> **Set the ownership type correctly the first time**
> Ownership type is read at the moment an invoice or a revenue-recognition entry is posted. Changing it after transactions exist will not restate what has already been posted.

How to use this help

- Every screen has a **Help** button at the top right. It opens the help for the screen you are on, in a panel beside your work.
- **System Setup** ▸ **Help** opens the Help Center, where you can search all topics or read them by menu.
- **Menu** ▸ **Screen** notation shows where to find each function, e.g. **Master Data** ▸ **Properties**.
- Green/red **Dr** / **Cr** tables show the exact journal the system posts. They are for reference — the system writes them for you.
- Read The System Workflow and Draft, Post & Reset to Draft first. Between them they explain most of what you will see.

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Signing In & Finding Your Way

Where: **Home**

Signing in

1. Open the application address in your browser. The **Login** page appears.
2. Enter the **Username** and **Password** issued by your administrator.
3. Select **Login**. You land on the **Dashboard**.

If you are a brand-new customer, use **Create New Company** on the login page. This registers a company, creates its first administrator, seeds the full chart of accounts and account mapping, creates the monthly accounting periods, and starts a 15-day trial.

The navigation bar

Menu	Contains
Home	The dashboard.
System Setup	Accounting setup — Chart of Accounts, Account Mapping, Opening Balances, Owner Withdrawal Categories, VAT Settings, Revenue Recognition, Recurring Prepayments, Period Closing. Administration (system administrators) — Companies, Users & Permissions, Audit Logs, Feedback Review. Subscription, Help, User Manual, Send Feedback.
Master Data	Properties, Units, Tenants, Leases, Vendors.
Operations	Workflow Guide. Tenant Services — Tenant Requests. Receivables — Customer Invoices, Customer Receipts, PDC Receipts, Security Deposits. Payables — Vendor Bills, Vendor Payments. General Ledger — Petty Cash, Fixed Assets, Manual Journals, Journal Inquiry.
Reporting	Financial — Trial Balance, Profit & Loss, Balance Sheet, Statement of Cash Flows, General Ledger, VAT Return. Management — Tenant Statement, Tenant Health & Ranking, Property Utilization, P&L by Property, Owner Tenancy Schedule, Owner Withdrawals.

> **Menus adapt to your permissions**
>
> You will only see the menus your account is entitled to. If a colleague can see a menu that you cannot, the difference is a permission, not a fault — see Companies, Users & Permissions.

Getting help on any screen

The **Help** button at the top right of every screen opens the instructions for the screen you are on, in a panel beside your work, so you can follow the steps without leaving the page. From the panel you can open the topic full-page, or go to the Help Center to search everything.

Switching company

If your user account has access to more than one company, a company selector appears at the top right. Choosing a different company reloads the current page in that company's data. Every list, report and balance in the system is filtered to the company you are currently in — you can never see another company's data by accident.

Changing your password

Select **Password** in the top-right corner, enter your current password, then the new password twice.

The Dashboard

Home shows the live operating picture: property and unit counts, occupancy rate, collections, outstanding receivables, liabilities and recent tenant activity. Use **Print Dashboard** for a clean printed snapshot.

Subscription status

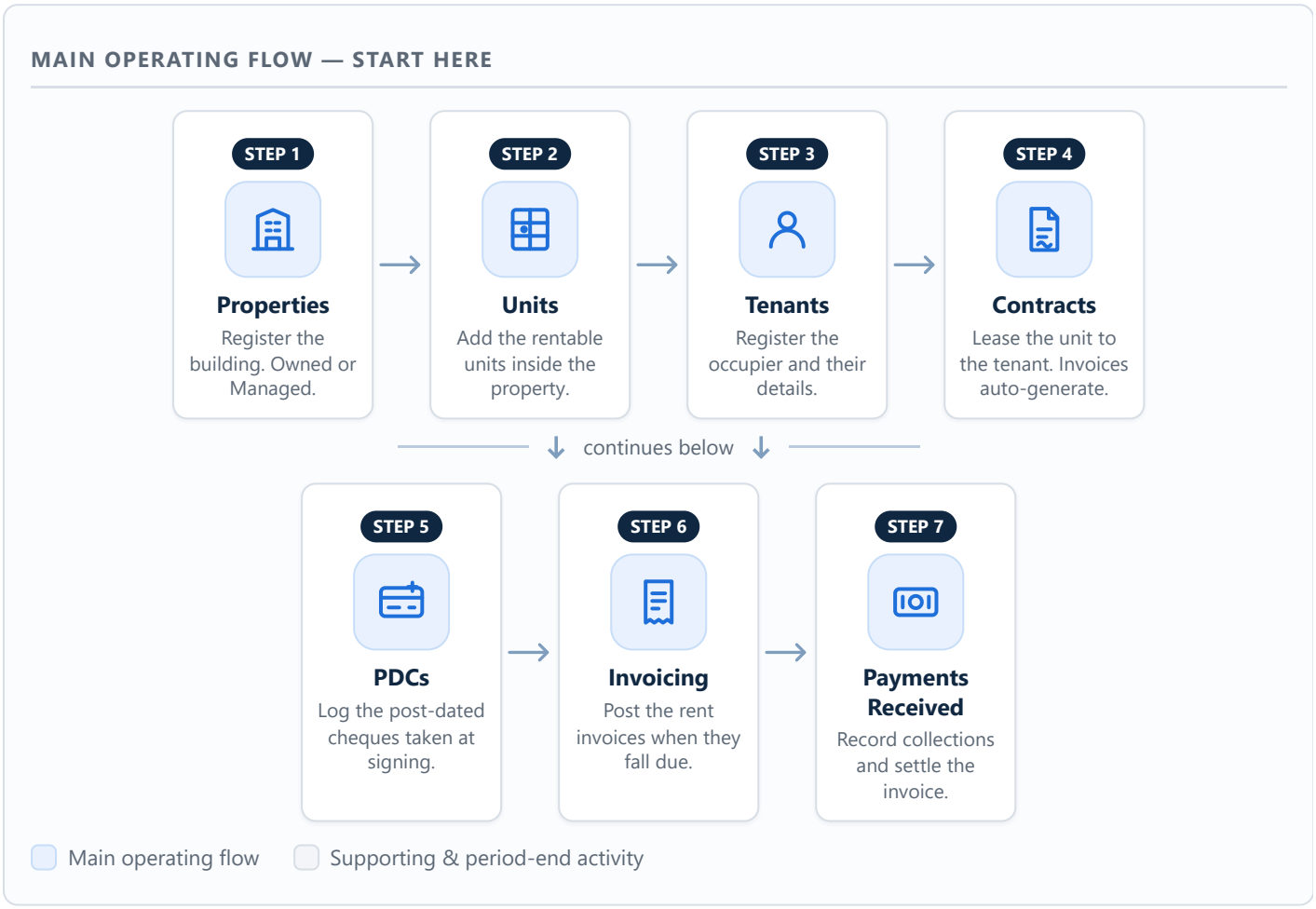
If the company's subscription expires, a red banner appears and the Master Data, Accounts and Reports menus are withdrawn until an activation code is entered under **System Setup ▸ Subscription**. Read-only access to Setup remains so that the subscription can be renewed.

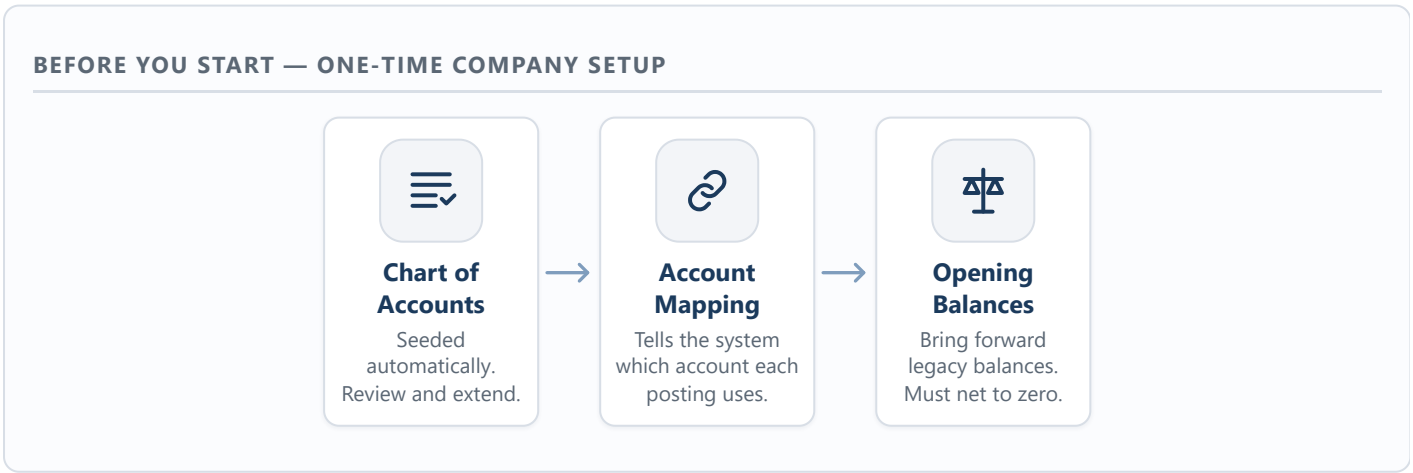
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The System Workflow

Where: **Operations** ▸ **Workflow Guide**

This is the operating map of RealEstateManager. Work left to right: each step depends on the one before it, because the record you create at each stage is selected in the next. The same diagram is available inside the application as a clickable home screen under **Operations** ▸ **Workflow Guide**.







What happens at each step

Step	Where	What it creates
1. Properties	Master Data ▸ Properties	The building record and its ownership type. No accounting.
2. Units	Master Data ▸ Units	Rentable units, each starting as *Vacant*. No accounting.
3. Tenants	Master Data ▸ Tenants	The tenant register and any opening receivable balance.
4. Contracts	Master Data ▸ Leases	The lease, **plus** the complete draft invoice schedule **plus** the monthly revenue-recognition plan. The unit becomes *Occupied*.
5. PDCs	Operations ▸ PDC Receipts	A cheque record and a memorandum journal dated on the received date (PDC On Hand / PDC Contra), saved as a draft to post.
6. Invoicing	Operations ▸ Customer Invoices	The receivable, the deferred-revenue liability and any VAT payable.
7. Payments	Operations ▸ Customer Receipts	A draft receipt. Once posted: cash in, receivable down, invoice status advanced to Partially Paid or Paid.

The one rule that makes the flow work

You cannot skip a step, because each screen selects a record created by the previous screen. There is no unit without a property, no lease without a unit and a tenant, no invoice without a lease, and no receipt without an invoice. If a dropdown is empty, the previous step has not been completed.

> **Post your drafts**
>
> Steps 5 and 7 save **draft** journals that do not reach the reports until posted from **Operations ▸ Journal Inquiry**. See Draft, Post & Reset to Draft.

A typical first week

1. **Day 1 — Setup.** Review the Chart of Accounts, confirm Account Mapping, enter Opening Balances and confirm they are balanced.
2. **Day 2 — Portfolio.** Enter every property, then every unit under each property.
3. **Day 3 — People.** Enter tenants (with opening balances if migrating) and vendors.
4. **Day 4 — Contracts.** Enter each live lease. Check the generated invoice schedule after each one.
5. **Day 5 — Cheques.** Log the PDCs held against each lease.
6. **Day 6 — Verify.** Post every draft in Journal Inquiry, then run the Trial Balance and confirm total debit equals total credit.

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Draft, Post & Reset to Draft

Where: **Operations** ▸ **Journal Inquiry**

Every accounting transaction in RealEstateManager goes through three states, the same way Odoo works. Understanding this one idea explains why a transaction you have just saved may not yet appear in the Trial Balance.

State	What it means
Draft	The journal exists and can be reviewed, but it has **no effect on any report**. The Trial Balance, Balance Sheet, Profit & Loss, ledgers and statements all ignore drafts.
Posted	The journal is in the accounts. Every report includes it.
Reset to Draft	A posted journal pulled back out of the accounts so it can be corrected, then posted again.

Which screens post straight away, and which leave a draft

Screen	What Save / Post does
Customer Invoices, Vendor Bills	The **Post** button builds the journal *and* posts it in one click.
Customer Receipts, PDC Receipts, Security Deposits, Vendor Payments, Petty Cash, Manual Journals, Revenue Recognition, Recurring Prepayments	Saving creates a **draft** journal. You then post it from **Operations** ▸ **Journal Inquiry**.
Fixed Assets (acquisition, capitalisation, depreciation)	Posted immediately.

> **"I saved it but it is not in the Trial Balance"**
> That is almost always a draft waiting to be posted. Open **Operations** ▸ **Journal Inquiry**, set **Posted Only** to **No**, find the entry and press **Post**.

Posting drafts

1. Open **Operations** ▸ **Journal Inquiry**.
2. Set **Posted Only** to **No** so drafts are listed. Narrow it by date or source type if you like — for example only `CustomerReceipt` — and select **Go**.
3. Review each draft. Press **Post** on one entry, or **Post All Drafts** to post every draft that matches the current filter.

Post All Drafts posts each entry separately. If one cannot be posted — for example because its date falls in a closed period — the others still go through, and the message lists the ones that failed and why.

When Post is refused

Situation	What to do
The entry's date is in a **closed period**	Nothing can be posted into a closed period. Re-date the document into an open one, or post a journal there.
A **receipt** or **cheque clearance** whose invoice is still a draft	Post the invoice first, then the receipt or clearance.
A **vendor payment** whose bill is still a draft	Post the bill first, then the payment.

A settlement must never reach the accounts before the invoice or bill it settles, or Accounts Receivable or Accounts Payable would be reduced by an amount that was never added. In **Post All Drafts** the invoice or bill is normally dated earlier and so is posted first, and its settlement follows in the same run.

Correcting a posted transaction

1. Find the journal in Journal Inquiry and press **Reset to Draft**. It leaves the accounts immediately.
2. Correct the source document. A vendor bill, for instance, becomes editable again once its journal is a draft.
3. Post it again.

Resetting also undoes what posting did to the document. Resetting a receipt takes its amount back off the invoice it paid; resetting a cleared PDC puts the cheque back to *Received*.

When Reset to Draft is refused

Situation	Why, and what to do instead
The entry is in a **closed period**	Those figures have already been reported. Post a correcting journal in an open period.
An invoice has posted receipts or cleared cheques against it	The later transaction depends on it. Reset the receipts first, then the invoice.
A vendor bill has posted payments against it	Reset the payments first.
A PDC whose clearance has been posted	Reset the clearance entry first.
Year closing, prepayment set-up or amortisation, fixed asset postings	These create schedules or close a year, so unwinding them is not a simple reset. Post a reversing journal.

> **Closed periods are locked in both directions**
> Nothing can be posted *into* a closed period and nothing can be reset *out of* one. The list screens show a **Period locked** badge instead of the buttons when this applies.

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Master Data: Codes, Uniqueness & Who Can Edit

Where: **Master Data**

Properties, units, tenants, vendors and contracts are **master data**: the records everything else refers to. Three rules keep them clean.

1. The system issues the codes

You never type a code. It is generated when the record is saved, and it never changes afterwards because it is already printed on contracts, invoices and statements.

Record	Example	How it is built
Property	`OWN-R-0001`	**OWN** (owned) or **MNG** (managed), then the type — **R** residential, **C** commercial, **W** warehouse, **M** mixed use — then a running number.
Unit	`OWN-R-0001-U01`	The property code plus a unit number within that property.
Contract	`OWN-R-0001-U01-C001-2026`	The unit code, a tenancy number and the contract year. A **renewal** by the same tenant keeps the C number with the new year; a **new tenant** on the unit gets the next C number.
Tenant	`TNT-00001`	A running number for the company.
Vendor	`VEN-0001`	A running number for the company.
Vendor bill	`BILL-2026-0001`	Year and running number. The supplier's own number is stored separately.
Tenant request	`REQ-2026-0001`	Year and running number.

The property create screen previews the code it will issue as you choose the ownership and type.

2. The same party cannot be entered twice

A tenant or supplier set up twice under two codes splits their balance in two, so statements are wrong and the same debt gets chased twice. The system refuses a duplicate of any of these, within a company:

- **Tenants** — trade licence number, Emirates ID / ID number, passport number, TRN.
- **Vendors** — trade licence number, TRN.
- **Properties** — the property name.

The message names the record that already holds the value, for example *Trade licence number "1234" is already registered to TNT-00007 – Al Noor Trading*. Open that record instead of creating a second one.

Blank values are never treated as duplicates. Any number of records may have no passport number on file.

3. Only the master data owners can create or change records

Permission	What the user can do
View Master Data	Open the lists and look records up. The **Add** and **Edit** buttons are not shown, and a note explains why.
Create & Edit Master Data	Add and amend properties, units, tenants and vendors, and issue tenant portal logins.

Accounting users can always look vendors up, because they need to find the supplier to enter a bill, but they cannot create one. Grant **Create & Edit** only to the small group responsible for master data — see Companies, Users & Permissions.

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Chart of Accounts

Where: **System Setup** ▸ **Chart of Accounts**

The chart of accounts is the backbone of the ledger. A complete five-digit chart is created automatically for every new company, so in most cases you review it rather than build it.

How the codes are organised

Range	Group	Nature
`10000`	Assets	Debit
`20000`	Liabilities	Credit
`30000`	Equity	Credit
`40000`	Revenue	Credit
`50000`	Direct Expenses	Debit
`60000`	General Expenses	Debit

The six codes above are **group** headers: they organise the tree and cannot be posted to. Detail accounts sit beneath them. The full seeded list is in Chart of Accounts Reference.

Reading the tree

Accounts are shown as an expandable tree with the account code, name, type, reporting group and current balance. Group rows are shown in bold and have no **Edit** action for posting purposes.

Adding an account

1. Select **New Account**.
2. Enter a **Code** that fits the range of its parent — a new expense account under General Expenses should begin with `6`.
3. Enter the **Name**, choose the **Account Type** and the **Reporting Group**. These two drive how the account behaves in the reports.
4. Choose the **Parent Account** so the account appears in the right branch of the tree.
5. Leave **Is Postable** ticked for a detail account; untick it (and tick **Is Group**) for a heading.
6. Set the **Opening Balance** only if you are migrating from another system — see Opening Balances.
7. **Save**.

Field	Meaning
Code	Unique five-digit identifier within the company. Determines sort order in every report.
Account Type	Asset, Liability, Equity, Revenue or Expense. Determines the account's natural balance side and whether it appears on the Balance Sheet or the P&L.
Reporting Group	Assets, Liabilities, Equity, Revenue, DirectExpense or GeneralExpense. Controls the section the account is presented in.
Is Control Account	Marks an account whose balance is owned by a sub-ledger (Accounts Receivable, Accounts Payable, Fixed Assets). See the warning below.
Is Group / Is Postable	A group account is a heading and cannot receive journal lines. A postable account can.
Owner Account (Edit screen)	Equity accounts only. Set to *Yes* for an owner's current account, so its journal lines can carry an owner withdrawal category.
Petty Cash Float (Edit screen)	Asset accounts only. Set to *Yes* for a petty cash float, so it appears on the Petty Cash screen.
Is Active	Untick to retire an account without deleting its history.
Opening Balance	Manual opening balance in natural form: positive means a debit balance for asset/expense accounts and a credit balance for liability/equity/revenue accounts.

> **Control accounts take their opening balance from the sub-ledger**
> For Accounts Receivable, Accounts Payable and the fixed-asset accounts, the opening balance is *calculated* from the tenants, vendors and assets beneath them. Typing an opening balance directly onto those accounts has no effect — enter it on the tenant, vendor or asset instead.

The opening balance check

The top of the screen totals every account's opening balance and checks the accounting equation: **Assets = Liabilities + Equity**.

- A **green** banner means the opening balances agree.
- A **red** banner means they do not, and shows the difference. Your Trial Balance and Balance Sheet will be out by exactly that amount until it is fixed — see Opening Balances.

Accounts you should not remove

Several accounts are referenced by the automatic postings. Deactivating one of them will cause the related transaction to fail with a mapping error. Before retiring any account, check Account Mapping (Account Mapping) to confirm it is not in use.

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Account Mapping

Where: **System Setup** ▸ **Account Mapping**

Account Mapping is the bridge between the operational side of the system and the ledger. When you post a customer receipt, the system needs to know *which* account is "cash" and *which* is "accounts receivable". Account Mapping answers exactly that question, once, for the whole company.

Defaults are applied automatically when a company is created, so the system works out of the box. You change a mapping only when your chart of accounts differs from the standard one — for example if you open a dedicated bank account and want receipts to land there instead of in `11100`.

The mappings

Mapping	Default	Used by
Default Cash	`11100`	Customer receipts, security deposits, PDC clearance, vendor payments
Accounts Receivable	`11200`	Customer invoices, receipts, PDC settlement
VAT Recoverable	`11300`	Vendor bills
PDC On Hand	`11400`	PDC memorandum and clearance
Prepaid Expense (default)	`11500`	Recurring prepayments
Investment Property	`15100`	Property capitalisation
Fixed Asset (default)	`15200`	Fixed asset capitalisation
Accumulated Depreciation (default)	`15300`	Depreciation postings
Fixed Asset Clearing	`15400`	Acquisition cost accumulation before capitalisation
Accounts Payable	`21100`	Vendor bills and payments
Advances from Customers	`21200`	PDC cleared as an advance
Unearned Revenue	`21200`	Owned-property invoicing and revenue release
Tenant Security Deposit Liability	`21300`	Security deposits
VAT Payable	`21400`	Customer invoices
Due to Landlords	`21500`	Managed-property invoicing and commission release
PDC Contra	`21600`	PDC memorandum and its reversal
Retained Earnings – Prior Years	`32100`	Fiscal year closing
Current Year Profit or Loss	`33100`	Fiscal year closing
Rental Revenue – Owned	`41100`	Revenue recognition (owned)
Management Fee Revenue	`42100`	Revenue recognition (managed)
Other Income	`43100`	Miscellaneous income
Direct Expense (default)	`51100`	Vendor bills with a direct expense category
General Expense (default)	`61100`	Vendor bills with a general expense category
Depreciation Expense	`62100`	Depreciation postings
Finance Cost	`63100`	Interest and bank charges

Changing a mapping

1. Open **System Setup** ▸ **Account Mapping**.
2. Choose the replacement account from the dropdown beside the mapping you want to change.

3. **Save**.

> **Mapping changes are not retrospective**
>
> Changing a mapping affects **future** postings only. Journals already posted keep the account they were posted to. If you re-point "Default Cash" to a new bank account mid-year, the earlier balance stays in the old account and must be moved with a manual journal.

> **If a posting fails with a mapping error**
>
> A message such as "*Account mapping for Default Cash is not configured*" means the mapping is empty or points at an account that has been deleted or deactivated. Open Account Mapping, select a valid account, save, and retry the posting.

SYSTEM SETUP · 8

Opening Balances

Where: **System Setup ▸ Opening Balances**

Opening balances carry your position from a previous system into RealEstateManager. This screen is both the place where you verify them and the single most important control in the whole setup.

Where each opening balance is entered

Balance	Entered on	Screen
Ordinary GL accounts (cash, equity, loans…)	The account itself	**System Setup ▸ Chart of Operations ▸ Edit**
Accounts Receivable	Each tenant	**Master Data ▸ Tenants ▸ Edit**
Accounts Payable	Each vendor	**Master Data ▸ Vendors ▸ Edit**
Fixed asset cost and accumulated depreciation	Each asset	**Operations ▸ Fixed Assets**

The control accounts are deliberately not editable directly. Their opening balance is always the sum of the sub-ledger beneath them, which guarantees that the receivables ledger and the AR control account can never drift apart.

Reading the reconciliation screen

The screen shows three summary cards — **Total Debit Opening Balance**, **Total Credit Opening Balance** and **Net Imbalance (Dr − Cr)** — followed by a per-account table showing, for each account, the manual opening balance, the sub-ledger total, the effective opening balance actually used, and its debit/credit presentation. Beneath the table are the tenant, vendor and fixed-asset detail lists that make up the control account totals.

> **Net Imbalance must be 0.00**
>
> Opening balances are added into the Trial Balance and Balance Sheet as figures, not as a posted journal. Nothing forces the debit side to equal the credit side. If the Net Imbalance card shows any value other than zero, **your Trial Balance will be out of balance by exactly that amount**, and your Balance Sheet will not balance either.
>
> The usual cause is entering asset opening balances (cash, receivables) without entering the matching credit-side opening balance on `31100` Share Capital or `32100` Retained Earnings – Prior Years.

Procedure for entering opening balances

1. Obtain the closing trial balance from your previous system as at the day before you go live.
2. Enter each **tenant's** outstanding balance on the tenant record. A positive value is an amount owed to you; a negative value is an advance you are holding.

3. Enter each **vendor's** outstanding balance on the vendor record.
4. Enter each **fixed asset's** opening cost and opening accumulated depreciation on the asset.
5. Enter every other balance directly on its **GL account** (cash, bank, loans, share capital, retained earnings).
6. Open **System Setup** ▸ **Opening Balances** and confirm **Net Imbalance = 0.00** with a green *Balanced* badge.
7. Run **Reporting** ▸ **Trial Balance** and confirm total debit equals total credit.

> **Balancing figure**
> If your legacy trial balance was itself balanced, the figure that makes the Net Imbalance zero is your retained earnings. Post it to `32100` Retained Earnings – Prior Years, not to a suspense account.

The opening balance control account (39999)

If you create account `39999` *Opening Balance Control Account* (Equity), the system uses it to keep the opening position balanced automatically: any difference between the debit and credit opening balances is placed on `39999`, so the Trial Balance and Balance Sheet always balance.

Treat a balance on `39999` as a **to-do list, not an answer**. It means something was entered on one side only. When the missing figure is found and entered, `39999` returns to zero. Before closing the first year, clear whatever is left to `32100` Retained Earnings – Prior Years with a manual journal, once you are satisfied it really is retained earnings.

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Owner Withdrawal Categories

Where: **System Setup** ▸ **Owner Withdrawal Categories**

Categories are the list used to tag what an owner's withdrawals were spent on — school fees, travel, household costs. They are an analysis dimension on the owner's equity account, not expense accounts, so company profit is never affected. See Owner Withdrawals Explained for the reasoning.

A starter set is created for every company and can be renamed, reordered, deactivated or replaced entirely:

Code	Category	Typical use
`OW-10`	Cash Drawings	Cash taken for personal use
`OW-20`	Household & Living	Groceries, utilities, household running costs
`OW-30`	Education	School and university fees
`OW-40`	Travel	Personal travel and accommodation
`OW-50`	Vehicles	Personal vehicles, servicing, fuel
`OW-60`	Medical & Insurance	Personal medical and insurance
`OW-70`	Charity & Donations	Personal giving
`OW-80`	Personal Investments	Funds moved to private investments
`OW-99`	Other Personal	Anything that fits nowhere else

1. Select **New Category**.
2. Enter a unique **Code** and a **Name**.
3. Add a **Description** so other users apply it consistently.
4. Set the **Sort Order** to control where it appears in the selector and the report.
5. **Save**.

The list screen shows, for each category, how many posted journal lines use it and the net amount posted against it — so you can see at a glance which categories are actually being used.

> **Deactivate rather than delete**
>
> A category already used by a posted journal cannot be removed, because those journals reference it. Untick **Active** instead: it disappears from the General Journal selector while every journal already posted against it, and every historical report, stays exactly as it was.

SYSTEM SETUP · 10

VAT Settings

Where: **System Setup** ▸ **VAT Settings**

Your company's VAT identity and one recovery setting. Fill this in once, before you issue the first tax invoice.

Tax identity

Field	Why it matters
TRN	Your Tax Registration Number. Printed on every tax invoice. **Leave it blank if the company is not VAT registered** — the system then issues ordinary invoices with no VAT.
Legal Name	The registered name, if it differs from the trading name. A tax invoice must show it.
Address, City, Country	Required on a tax invoice.
Phone, Email	Printed in the invoice header.

Until a TRN and address are entered, the screen shows *Tax invoices cannot be issued yet* and the **Setup Readiness** panel lists what is missing.

Input tax recovery

A business that lets both commercial property (VAT at 5%) and residential property (exempt) can reclaim VAT on its costs only in proportion to its taxable activity. Costs clearly belonging to one side are handled on the bill line — *Taxable* or *Exempt*. Shared overheads such as head-office costs are **Residual**, and for those a percentage is used during the year:

Field	Meaning
Provisional recovery rate (%)	The share of residual input VAT reclaimed on each bill during the year. Normally last year's actual rate. **100** if all your lettings are commercial.

At year end the VAT Return works out the rate you actually earned and shows the correction (the *wash-up*).

> **Where VAT is decided**
>
> - **On rent** — by the VAT category of the property or unit, copied to the contract and then onto each invoice. See Lease Contracts.
> - **On costs** — by whether the supplier is VAT registered, and by each bill line's attribution. See Vendor Bills.

SYSTEM SETUP · 11

Revenue Recognition

Where: **System Setup** ▸ **Revenue Recognition**

This screen turns billed rent into earned revenue, one month at a time. It is the mechanism that keeps the Profit & Loss faithful to the period rather than to the billing cycle.

How the schedule is built

When a lease is saved, one planned entry is created for the last day of every month in the lease term, each for one-twelfth of the annual rent. Every entry starts with status **Planned**.

Running the recognition

1. Open **System Setup** ▸ **Revenue Recognition**. Planned and posted entries are listed.
2. Enter the **cut-off date** — normally the last day of the month you are closing.
3. Select **Post All Due Up To Selected Date**, or **Post** on a single entry. A journal is created for every planned entry dated on or before the cut-off, oldest first.
4. Post those journals from Journal Inquiry. Each entry's status then changes to **Posted**.

> **These buttons create draft journals**
>
> They reach the Profit & Loss only once posted from **Operations** ▸ **Journal Inquiry** — filter the Source Type to `RevenueRecognitionSchedule` and use **Post All Drafts**. See Draft, Post & Reset to Draft.

Owned property

Account	Debit	Credit
`21200` Advances from Customers	Monthly amount	—
`41100` Rental Revenue – Owned	—	Monthly amount

Managed property

Account	Debit	Credit
`21500` Due to Landlords	Monthly amount	—
`42100` Management Fee Revenue	—	Monthly amount

> **Make this the first task of every month-end**
>
> Run revenue recognition before printing the Profit & Loss. If you skip it, revenue for the month is missing and the deferred-income balance is overstated by the same amount. Running it late is safe: each entry keeps its own month-end date, so the figures land in the correct period.

Reading the deferred balance

At any date, the balance on `21200` Advances from Customers is the rent you have billed but not yet earned. It should equal the sum of all planned (unposted) recognition entries for invoices already posted. This is a useful monthly reconciliation.

SYSTEM SETUP · 12

Recurring Prepayments

Where: **System Setup** ▸ **Recurring Prepayments**

Use a prepayment schedule when you pay once for something consumed over many months — annual insurance, a trade licence, a maintenance contract. The cost is parked on the balance sheet and released to the Profit & Loss evenly.

Creating a schedule

1. Select **New Prepayment**.
2. Enter a **Description** and choose the **Prepayment Type**.
3. Enter the **Payment Date** and the **Total Amount**.
4. Enter the **First Recognition Date** (normalised to a month end) and the **Recognition Months**.
5. Choose the **Prepaid Account** (default `11500`) and the **Expense Account** the cost belongs in.
6. Choose the **Offset Account** — cash if you paid directly, or Accounts Payable with a **Vendor** if it is on credit.
7. **Save**.

Saving creates the setup journal as a draft; post it from Journal Inquiry:

Account	Debit	Credit
`11500` Prepaid Expenses	Total amount	—
Offset — `11100` Cash or `21100` Accounts Payable	—	Total amount

Monthly amortisation

Each month end, select **Post All Due Up To Selected Date** to release the instalments due, then post the resulting drafts from Journal Inquiry:

Account	Debit	Credit
Expense account chosen on the schedule	Monthly amount	—
`11500` Prepaid Expenses	—	Monthly amount

When the final instalment posts, the schedule is marked **Completed** and the prepaid balance for it is nil.

> **Prepayment postings cannot be reset to draft**
>
> Once posted, set-up and amortisation entries create and consume a schedule, so they cannot simply be reset. To correct one, post a reversing manual journal.

SYSTEM SETUP · 13

Period & Year Closing

Where: **System Setup** ▸ **Period Closing**

Closing locks a period so that its reported figures cannot change afterwards. The screen shows the twelve monthly periods of the selected fiscal year with their status, and the history of fiscal years already closed.

Month-end checklist

1. Post every customer invoice dated in the month.
2. Record every customer receipt and clear every PDC that the bank honoured.
3. Post every vendor bill and vendor payment.
4. Run **Revenue Recognition** to the month-end date.
5. Run **Depreciation** to the month-end date.
6. Process **Prepayment** amortisation for the month.
7. Post any accruals or adjustments as manual journals.
8. In **Operations** ▸ **Journal Inquiry**, set **Posted Only** to **No** for the month and **Post All Drafts**. Nothing left in draft is in the figures you are about to lock.
9. Run the **Trial Balance** and confirm debits equal credits.
10. Review the **Profit & Loss** and **Balance Sheet**.
11. Return to **System Setup** ▸ **Period Closing** and **Close Period**.

> **Closing locks the period both ways**
> After a period is closed, nothing can be posted into it and nothing in it can be reset to draft. Late documents go into the next open period — for vendor bills, use the **Accounting Date**. Corrections are made with a journal in an open period.

Closing the fiscal year

After the final period of the year is closed and reviewed, use **Close Year**. The system posts a closing journal that transfers the net result of every revenue and expense account into equity:

Account	Debit	Credit
Each revenue account (cleared to nil)	Balance	—
Each expense account (cleared to nil)	—	Balance
`32100` Retained Earnings – Prior Years	Net loss	Net profit

The closing is recorded with its fiscal year, the profit or loss amount, the timestamp and a link to the journal, so it is fully auditable.

> **Close each year before reporting on the next**
>
> The Balance Sheet presents the current fiscal year's profit as a separate equity line and takes prior years from Retained Earnings. If a year is never closed, its profit stays in the revenue and expense accounts — which the Balance Sheet does not present — and the Balance Sheet will not balance once you cross into the following year.

SYSTEM SETUP · 14

Companies, Users & Permissions

Where: **System Setup** ▸ **Users & Permissions**

Companies

System Setup ▸ **Companies** — system administrators only.

Each company is a completely separate set of books with its own chart of accounts, master data and ledger. Creating a company automatically seeds its chart of accounts, its account mapping and its monthly accounting periods.

Field	Meaning
Name	Appears in the company selector and on reports.
Base Currency	Reporting currency, e.g. AED.
Fiscal Year Start Month	1 for a January–December year. Drives accounting periods and the Balance Sheet's current-year profit calculation.

Users

System Setup ▸ **Users & Permissions** — system administrators only.

1. Select **New User**.
2. Enter the **Username**, **Display Name** and an initial **Password**.
3. Grant access to one or more **Companies**.
4. Tick the **Permissions** the user needs.
5. **Save** and give the user their credentials. They should change the password at first login.

The permissions

Permission	Group	Grants access to
View Master Data	Master Data	Look up properties, units, tenants and vendors. Read only.
Create & Edit Master Data	Master Data	Add and amend properties, units, tenants and vendors; issue tenant portal logins. Implies View.
Manage Leases	Operations	Lease contracts, the draft contract and QR label.
Handle Tenant Requests	Operations	The Tenant Requests queue: replying, changing status, applying agreed postponements.
Manage Accounting	Accounting	Invoices, receipts, PDCs, bills, payments, deposits, petty cash, fixed assets, prepayments, revenue recognition, journals, accounting setup and closing. Also lets the user look vendors up.
View Reports	Reporting	All financial and management reports.

Suggested role profiles

Role	Permissions
Master data owner	Create & Edit Master Data · Manage Leases
Leasing officer	View Master Data · Manage Leases · Handle Tenant Requests
Property / facilities manager	View Master Data · Handle Tenant Requests
Accountant	View Master Data · Manage Accounting · View Reports
Owner / auditor	View Reports only
Administrator	The System Administrator role, which bypasses every permission check

> **Keep Create & Edit Master Data to a few people**
>
> Master data is centralised so the same tenant or supplier is never set up twice. Give most users *View Master Data*, and *Create & Edit* only to the people who own the data. See Master Data rules.

> **Permissions are enforced at the server**
>
> Hiding a menu is not the control — the server independently refuses any request the user is not entitled to make. Typing a URL directly will not bypass a permission.

SYSTEM SETUP · 15

Subscription, Audit Log & Feedback

Where: **System Setup** ▸ **Subscription & Help**

Subscription

System Setup ▸ Subscription

Shows the company's current subscription state, its expiry date and the days remaining. New companies start on a 15-day trial. To extend, enter the activation code supplied by your provider and select **Activate**. When a subscription expires, processing menus are withdrawn until it is renewed; no data is lost.

Audit Logs

System Setup ▸ Audit Logs — system administrators only.

Records who did what and when across the application. Filter by user, date range, action or entity to investigate a change. Combined with Journal Inquiry, this gives a complete evidence trail: the audit log shows the user action, the journal shows its accounting consequence.

Help

System Setup ▸ Help

The Help Center: every help topic, grouped the same way as the menus, with a search box. The **Help** button on any screen opens just that screen's topic. **System Setup ▸ User Manual** opens the complete manual as one printable document, with a PDF to download.

Feedback

System Setup ▸ Send Feedback

Submit a problem report or an improvement request. Include the screen name, what you did, what you expected and what happened, plus any document number involved — that is usually enough to resolve an issue without further correspondence. Administrators review submissions under **System Setup ▸ Feedback Review**.

MASTER DATA · 16

Properties

Where: **Master Data** ▸ **Properties**

Workflow step 1. A property is a building or a site. It is the top of the portfolio hierarchy and the anchor for every unit, lease, invoice and expense beneath it.

Creating a property

1. Select **Add Property**.
2. Choose the **Ownership Type** — *this is the field that drives the accounting*.
3. Choose the **Property Type**: Residential, Commercial, Warehouse or Mixed Use. The screen previews the code the property will receive, such as `OWN-R-0001`.
4. Enter the **Name** and **Address**. The name must be unique in the company.
5. Choose the default **VAT Category** for its units — Standard for commercial, Exempt for residential.
6. For a managed property, enter the **Owner Name** and the **Commission Percentage** you earn.
7. Enter the **Asset Value** if you track the property's book value, then save.

Field	Meaning
Code	Issued by the system and fixed once saved. Built from ownership and type — see Master Data rules.
Ownership Type	**Owned** — rent is your revenue. **Managed** — rent belongs to the landlord; only your commission is revenue.
Property Type	Classification for reporting, and part of the code.
VAT Category	Default VAT treatment for units in this property. A unit can override it, which is what makes a mixed-use building work: commercial units at 5%, residential units exempt, under one roof.
Owner Name	The landlord. Used to group the Owner Tenancy Schedule.
Commission Percentage	Your management fee rate on a managed property.
Asset Value	Reference book value. Does not itself post to the ledger.
Is Active	Untick to remove a disposed property from selection lists while keeping its history.

> **Ownership type is decisive**
>
> Owned and Managed produce entirely different journals for the same invoice. Confirm the ownership type before you create any lease under the property — see Accounting Entries Reference.

Read only?

If you can see the list but not the **Add** and **Edit** buttons, your account has *View Master Data* only. Ask the master data owner to make the change.

MASTER DATA · 17

Units

Where: **Master Data** ▸ **Units**

Workflow step 2. A unit is an individually rentable space inside a property: an apartment, an office, a shop, a warehouse bay. Leases are signed against units, not against properties.

Creating a unit

1. Select **Add Unit**.
2. Choose the **Property**. The unit receives the next code under it, such as `OWN-R-0001-U01`.
3. Enter the **Floor** and the **Usage Type**.
4. Enter the **Area (sq ft)** and the **Standard Annual Rent**.
5. Leave **VAT Category** blank to inherit the property's, or set it for a unit that is treated differently — a shop on the ground floor of a residential tower, for example.
6. Leave **Status** as *Vacant*; the system changes it automatically. Save.

Field	Meaning
Unit code	Issued by the system, unique within its property.
Area (sq ft)	Used for rent-per-square-foot and area utilization.
Standard Annual Rent	The asking rent. Offered as the default when a lease is created, and editable there.
VAT Category	Blank means inherit the property's. Set it only to override.
Status	Vacant · Occupied · Under Maintenance · Reserved.

> **Status is maintained for you**
>
> An active lease sets the unit to **Occupied** automatically. Set the status yourself only for *Under Maintenance* or *Reserved*, which keep the unit out of the leasing flow.

The list is grouped by property so you can see each building's units and their occupancy together. Occupancy figures on the dashboard and in Property Utilization come from unit status, so keeping it accurate keeps the reporting accurate.

MASTER DATA · 18

Tenants

Where: **Master Data** ▸ **Tenants**

Workflow step 3. The tenant register is the receivables sub-ledger. Every tenant's balance rolls up into the `11200` Accounts Receivable control account.

Creating a tenant

1. Select **Add Tenant**. The tenant code, such as `TNT-00001`, is issued when you save.
2. Enter the **Full Name** exactly as it should appear on contracts, invoices and statements.
3. Enter **Email**, **Phone**, **Nationality** and **Address**.
4. Enter the identifiers you hold: **Trade Licence Number** for a company, **Emirates ID / ID Number** and **Passport Number** for an individual.
5. Enter the **TRN** if the tenant is VAT registered.
6. Enter the **Opening Balance** only when migrating from another system. Save.

Field	Meaning
Trade licence, Emirates ID, passport, TRN	Each must be unique in the company. If another tenant already holds one, the save is refused and that tenant is named — open the existing record rather than creating a second one.
TRN	A tenant with a TRN receives a **full tax invoice** showing it; without one, a **simplified tax invoice**.
Opening Balance	**Positive** — the tenant owes you at go-live. **Negative** — an advance you are holding for them. Feeds the AR control account.
Is Active	Untick when the tenant leaves. History and statements are kept.

> **Opening balances need a credit counterpart**
>
> Tenant opening balances add to the debit side of the opening trial balance. Check **System Setup** ▸ **Opening Balances** afterwards — see Opening Balances.

Giving the tenant portal access

The **Portal** button on a tenant's row issues them a login to the self-service portal, where they can see their account and send requests. See The Tenant Portal: Staff Guide.

The tenant's statement

Reporting ▸ **Tenant Statement** produces the tenant's running account: opening balance, every charge and payment in date order, and the closing balance. Use it for collection calls and for confirming a balance with the tenant.

MASTER DATA · 19

Vendors

Where: **Master Data** ▸ **Vendors**

Vendors are your suppliers and service providers — maintenance contractors, utilities, agencies. The vendor register is the payables sub-ledger and rolls up into `21100` Accounts Payable.

Creating a vendor

1. Select **Add Vendor**. The vendor code, such as `VEN-0001`, is issued when you save.
2. Enter the **Name**, **Service Type**, **Contact Person**, **Phone** and **Email**.
3. Enter the **Trade Licence Number**.
4. Enter the **TRN**, and tick **VAT registered (active)** only if their registration is currently live.
5. Enter the **Opening Balance** only when migrating — positive means you owe the vendor. Save.

Why "VAT registered" matters

This tick box decides how every bill from this supplier is treated:

Vendor is…	Their bills
VAT registered and has a TRN	Are **tax invoices**. Taxable lines carry 5% VAT, which you can reclaim to the extent the cost relates to taxable supplies.
Not registered	Are **commercial invoices**. No VAT is calculated anywhere on the bill, and the whole amount is a direct cost.

A registered supplier must have a TRN on file — the system will not save the tick without one. Untick it when a supplier's registration is cancelled; bills already entered keep the treatment they were entered with.

> **No duplicates**
>
> A trade licence number or TRN can belong to only one vendor in the company. If you try to enter an existing supplier again, the save is refused and the existing vendor is named.

Accounting users can look vendors up to enter bills, but only users with *Create & Edit Master Data* can add or change one — see Master Data rules.

MASTER DATA · 20

Lease Contracts

Where: **Master Data** ▸ **Leases**

The lease is the pivot of the whole system. Saving one lease creates, in a single action, the contract, its contract code, the entire schedule of rent invoices for its term, and the month-by-month revenue-recognition plan.

Creating a lease

1. Select **New Lease**.
2. Choose the **Unit** and the **Tenant**.
3. Enter the **Start Date** and **End Date**.
4. Enter the **Annual Rent** for the full contract year.
5. Choose the **Billing Frequency (Months)** — it must divide 12 exactly: 1, 2, 3, 4, 6 or 12.
6. Check the **VAT treatment** shown for the unit. Override it only with a reason (see below).
7. Enter the **Security Deposit Amount** agreed in the contract and any **Notes**.
8. **Save**.

The contract code

You do not type a contract number. The system issues one from the unit code, a tenancy number and the year, for example `OWN-R-0001-U01-C001-2026`:

- The **same tenant renewing** the same unit keeps the tenancy number with the new year — `…-C001-2027`.
- A **new tenant** on the unit receives the next tenancy number — `…-C002-2027`.

So a glance at the code tells you the building, the unit, which tenancy on that unit it is, and which year. See Master Data: Codes, Uniqueness & Who Can Edit.

VAT treatment

The VAT category comes from the unit, or from its property if the unit does not set one:

Category	Rate	Typical use
Standard	5%	Commercial property — offices, shops, warehouses.
Exempt	—	Residential lettings after the first supply. No VAT is charged and VAT on related costs cannot be reclaimed.
Zero-rated	0%	The first supply of a new residential building. No VAT charged, but related input VAT can be reclaimed.

If a specific contract genuinely needs different treatment, choose a **VAT category override** and enter the **reason**. The reason is kept on the contract so the decision can be explained later.

What is generated automatically

Invoice schedule. The annual rent is divided by the number of invoices per year (12 ÷ billing frequency). One draft invoice is created for each billing date from the start date until the end date. VAT is calculated per invoice from the contract's VAT category.

Revenue-recognition plan. One planned entry for the last day of every month in the term, each for one-twelfth of the annual rent. This spreads the rent evenly over time however it was billed or collected.

Unit status. The unit becomes *Occupied* and the lease *Active*.

> **Worked example**
>
> Annual rent 175,000, billed quarterly, one-year term starting 1 January:
>
> - 4 invoices of 43,750 each, dated 1 Jan, 1 Apr, 1 Jul, 1 Oct.
> - 12 revenue-recognition entries of 14,583.33 each, at each month end.
>
> After eight months, 116,666.64 has been recognised as revenue and 58,333.36 remains in *Advances from Customers* as deferred income.

Printing the contract and its label

Each lease in the list has two print buttons, both opening in a new tab:

Button	What it produces
Draft Contract	A full tenancy agreement filled in from the lease: parties, premises, term and rent, payment schedule, **schedule of charges** for breach and damage, use of the premises, maintenance and damage, security deposit, breach and termination, utilities, insurance and access. Review it with your legal adviser before first use.
QR Label	A label carrying the contract code and a QR code, to stick on the file or the signed copy so it can be scanned back to the record.

What the system validates

Rule	Message you will see
End date after start date	"End date must be later than start date."
Billing frequency divides 12	"Billing frequency must be 1, 2, 3, 4, 6, or 12."
No overlapping active lease on the same unit	"This unit already has an overlapping active lease."

> **Editing a lease does not regenerate its schedules**
> Changing the rent, dates or billing frequency of an existing lease updates the contract only. Invoices and revenue-recognition entries already generated are left as they are. If commercial terms change materially, end the lease and raise a new contract, then cancel any unposted invoices from the old one.

Lease statuses

Status	Meaning
Draft	Being prepared. Not yet operative.
Active	In force. Only active leases appear on the PDC screen.
Terminated	Ended early.
Expired	Ran to its natural end date.
Renewed	Superseded by a successor contract.

OPERATIONS · 21

Customer Invoices

Where: **Operations** ▸ **Customer Invoices**

Workflow step 6. Rent invoices are created for you when the lease is saved. Your job on this screen is to post them when they fall due, print them for the tenant, and receive payment against them.

The invoice list

The list shows the invoice number, date, tenant, unit, subtotal, VAT, total, amount paid and status. Invoices generated from a lease begin in **Draft**: they exist as documents but have not touched the ledger.

Posting an invoice

1. Locate the invoice in the list.
2. Select **Post**. The journal is built and posted in one step, and the status becomes **Posted**.

The journal takes the **invoice date**, not the date you press Post. An invoice dated in a closed period cannot be posted.

Owned property

Account	Debit	Credit
`11200` Accounts Receivable	Total (rent + VAT)	—
`21200` Advances from Customers (unearned revenue)	—	Subtotal
`21400` VAT Payable (only if VAT > 0)	—	VAT

Managed property

Account	Debit	Credit
`11200` Accounts Receivable	Total (rent + VAT)	—
`21500` Due to Landlords	—	Subtotal
`21400` VAT Payable (only if VAT > 0)	—	VAT

> **Why invoicing does not create revenue**
>
> Billing and earning are different events. Issuing a rent invoice creates a receivable and an obligation to provide occupancy — not revenue. Revenue arrives month by month through Revenue Recognition, which is what keeps the Profit & Loss smooth even when a tenant is billed a year in advance.

Printing the invoice

The **Tax Invoice** button (or **Invoice**, when no VAT is charged) opens the printable document in a new tab.

Document	When it is issued
Full tax invoice	VAT is charged and the tenant has a TRN on file. Shows both TRNs.
Simplified tax invoice	VAT is charged and the tenant has no TRN.
Invoice	No VAT is charged — an exempt residential letting, for example.

Tax invoices are numbered in a **single sequence for the whole company**, as UAE law requires. The VAT treatment is fixed on the invoice when it is generated, so a later change to the property or unit never rewrites an invoice already issued. Your own TRN, legal name and address come from VAT Settings.

Receiving payment

Receive on an invoice row opens a customer receipt already pointing at that invoice — see Customer Receipts.

Invoice statuses

Status	Meaning
Draft	Generated but not posted. No ledger impact.
Posted	Journal posted; receivable outstanding in full.
PartiallyPaid	Some payment posted; a balance remains.
Paid	Fully settled.
Cancelled	Voided. Excluded from PDC and receipt selection.

To correct a posted invoice, reset its journal to draft from Journal Inquiry — see Draft, Post & Reset to Draft. This is refused while receipts or cleared cheques are posted against it.

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Customer Receipts

Where: **Operations** ▸ **Customer Receipts**

Workflow step 7. A customer receipt records money collected from a tenant against a specific invoice — cash, bank transfer, or a cheque you are banking directly. Cheques handled through the PDC register clear themselves and do **not** need a receipt.

Recording a receipt

1. Select **New Receipt**, or **Receive** on the invoice in Customer Invoices.
2. Choose the **Invoice** being paid. Its outstanding balance is shown.
3. Enter the **Receipt Number** — unique within the company.
4. Enter the **Receipt Date** — the date the money actually arrived.
5. Enter the **Amount**. Part payments are allowed.
6. Choose the **Payment Method** and save.

> **The receipt is saved as a draft**
> It does not reduce the invoice or the tenant's balance until its journal is posted. Post it from **Operations** ▸ **Journal Inquiry** — see Draft, Post & Reset to Draft.

> **Only posted invoices can be received against**
> The invoice list shows posted invoices with a balance. A draft invoice is not yet a receivable, so a receipt against one is refused with *"Invoice … has not been posted yet"*. Post the invoice first; the **Receive** button on the invoice list only appears once it is posted.

Account	Debit	Credit
`11100` Cash and Cash Equivalents	Amount	—
`11200` Accounts Receivable	—	Amount

Effect on the invoice

When the receipt's journal is posted, the amount is added to the invoice's *Amount Paid* and its status moves to **PartiallyPaid** or **Paid**. Resetting the journal to draft takes it back off again.

> **One receipt, one invoice**
> Each receipt settles a single invoice. If a tenant pays one amount covering three invoices, enter three receipts with the same date and reference, splitting the amount. This keeps the tenant statement accurate at invoice level.

If saving fails

If the posting cannot be prepared — a missing account mapping, or a date in a closed period — nothing is saved and the message tells you why. You will not be left with a half-recorded receipt.

OPERATIONS · 23

PDC Receipts

Where: **Operations** ▸ **PDC Receipts**

Workflow step 5. Post-dated cheques are the normal way rent is secured in the region. A PDC is a cheque you hold today that the bank will only honour on a future date. The system tracks it in two stages, each with its own journal, so the cheque is visible in the accounts from the day you receive it without overstating cash.

> **Two dates, two different jobs**
>
> The **Received Date** is when the cheque came into your hands. The **Cheque Date** is the date written on it. The accounts record the cheque on the **received date** — that is when you hold it — not on the cheque date. The cheque date only matters when the cheque is banked.

Stage one — receiving the cheque

1. Select **New PDC** and choose the **Lease**. Only active leases are listed.
2. Choose the **Settlement Mode**:
   - **Receivable** — the cheque pays a specific invoice, which you then select. Only invoices with an outstanding balance appear.
   - **Advance** — the cheque is taken before any invoice exists and will sit as a customer advance.
3. Enter the **Cheque Number** (unique in the company) and the **Bank Name**.
4. Enter the **Received Date** — it cannot be in the future — and the **Cheque Date**, which cannot be earlier than the received date.
5. Enter the **Amount** and any **Notes**, then save.

Saving creates the memorandum journal, dated on the received date, as a **draft**. Post it from **Operations ▸ Journal Inquiry**; the cheque then shows as **Received**.

Account	Debit	Credit
`11400` PDC On Hand	Amount	—
`21600` PDC Contra	—	Amount

A memorandum pair: it records custody of the cheque without touching cash or receivables. Its net effect on the balance sheet is nil.

Correcting a cheque's details

Edit on a cheque lets you correct the received date, cheque date, cheque number, bank and notes — the usual fix when a cheque was keyed with the wrong date. Changing the received date re-dates the memorandum journal to match. The amount, lease and settlement mode cannot be changed here; if those are wrong, reset the journal and record the cheque again.

Stage two — clearing the cheque

1. When the bank honours the cheque, select **Clear** on it.
2. Enter the **Cleared Date**. It cannot be earlier than the received date.
3. If the cleared date is **before the cheque date**, you are warned that a bank will not normally honour a post-dated cheque early, and asked to confirm. Confirm only if the cheque really was presented early by agreement.
4. Save, then post the clearance journal from Journal Inquiry. The cheque becomes **Cleared**.

Account	Debit	Credit
`21600` PDC Contra (reverse memo)	Amount	—
`11400` PDC On Hand (reverse memo)	—	Amount
`11100` Cash and Cash Equivalents	Amount	—
`11200` Accounts Receivable (Receivable mode) `21200` Advances from Customers (Advance mode)	—	Amount

In Receivable mode, posting the clearance also settles the invoice — its *Amount Paid* rises and its status moves to PartiallyPaid or Paid.

> **The invoice must be posted before the cheque clears**
>
> In Receivable mode, clearing settles the invoice, so the invoice has to be in the accounts already. If it is still a draft, clearing is refused with "*Invoice … has not been posted yet*". Post the invoice, then clear the cheque. You can still *receive* a cheque against a draft invoice — the memorandum entry does not touch the receivable.

Validation rules

- Cheque number must be unique within the company.
- Amount must be greater than zero.
- In Receivable mode an invoice is required, it must belong to the selected lease, and the cheque cannot exceed the invoice's outstanding balance.
- A cheque cannot be cleared twice.

PDC statuses

Status	Meaning
Draft	Saved; memorandum journal not yet posted.
Received	Memorandum posted; the cheque is in your custody.
Cleared	Clearance posted; cash recorded and the memorandum reversed.

OPERATIONS · 24

Security Deposits

Where: **Operations** ▸ **Security Deposits**

A security deposit is money you hold on the tenant's behalf and expect to return at the end of the lease. It is never income. The system records it as a liability from the moment it is received.

Recording a deposit

1. Select **New Security Deposit** and choose the **Lease**.
2. Enter the **Reference Number**, the **Receipt Date** and the **Payment Method**.
3. Enter the **Amount** — normally the deposit agreed on the lease — and save.
4. Post the draft journal from **Operations** ▸ **Journal Inquiry**.

Account	Debit	Credit
`11100` Cash and Cash Equivalents	Amount	—
`21300` Tenant Security Deposits	—	Amount

> **Never treat a deposit as rent**
> Recording a deposit as a customer receipt would reduce the tenant's receivable and eventually show as revenue. Always use this screen. At the end of the lease, refund or forfeit the deposit with a manual journal that debits `21300`.

Releasing a deposit at lease end

Situation	Manual journal to post
Refunded in full	Dr `21300` Tenant Security Deposits · Cr `11100` Cash
Forfeited to cover damages	Dr `21300` Tenant Security Deposits · Cr `43100` Other Income
Applied against unpaid rent	Dr `21300` Tenant Security Deposits · Cr `11200` Accounts Receivable

The draft tenancy contract's **Schedule of Charges** sets out what may be deducted from the deposit, which is your basis for a forfeiture — see Lease Contracts.

OPERATIONS · 25

Vendor Bills

Where: **Operations** ▸ **Vendor Bills**

A vendor bill records a cost you have incurred and the obligation to pay the supplier. Bills are entered the way Odoo does it: a header for the supplier and the dates, and as many lines as the supplier's document has, each charged to its own account and property.

Entering a bill

1. Select **New Bill** and choose the **Supplier**. A coloured banner immediately tells you whether this supplier can charge VAT (see below).
2. Enter the **Supplier's Bill No.** — the number printed on their invoice. Your own bill number, such as `BILL-2026-0001`, is issued when you save.
3. Enter a **Category / Subject** to describe the bill on lists, e.g. *Building maintenance*.
4. Enter the **Bill Date** (the date on their document), the **Accounting Date** and the **Due Date**.
5. Optionally choose a **Default Property**. New lines pick it up automatically.
6. Fill in the **lines**: description, account, property, quantity, unit price, and for a VAT-registered supplier whether the line is taxable and its input tax attribution. **+ Add line** adds a row and **×** removes one. Totals update as you type.
7. Add any **Notes** and select **Save Draft**.
8. Review the bill, then select **Post**.

> **Bill date and accounting date**
> They are usually the same. They differ when a supplier's document arrives after its month has been closed: keep the supplier's date as the **bill date**, and set the **accounting date** in the open period. The accounting date decides which period the journal lands in.

VAT is decided by the supplier

Supplier	What happens on the bill
VAT registered with a TRN	Blue banner: *Tax Invoice — 5% VAT applies*. Taxable lines get 5% VAT, calculated for you.
Not registered	Amber banner: *Commercial Invoice — no VAT*. The VAT controls switch off, no VAT is calculated anywhere, and the full amount is charged to cost.

The supplier's registration is set on the vendor record — see Vendors. It is copied onto the bill when you save, so a later change to the vendor never alters a bill already entered.

Input tax attribution, line by line

How much of the VAT you can reclaim depends on what the cost was for. Set it on each line:

Attribution	Use for	Result
Taxable	Costs of commercial (standard-rated) property	VAT reclaimed in full.
Exempt	Costs of residential lettings	None reclaimed; the VAT is added to the cost of that line.
Residual	Overheads serving both, e.g. head office	Split by the provisional recovery rate in VAT Settings, corrected at year end.

Because attribution is per line, one supplier invoice covering a commercial tower and a residential block is handled correctly: one line reclaims, the other does not.

The journal

Account	Debit	Credit
Each line's own account, tagged with that line's property	Line net + any irrecoverable VAT	—
`11300` VAT Recoverable (only if any)	Total recoverable VAT	—
`21100` Accounts Payable	—	Bill total

VAT you cannot reclaim is never shown on its own line. It is part of what the item cost, so it is added to the line it belongs to.

Draft, post and reset

- A **draft** bill can be edited freely and has no effect on the accounts.
- **Post** builds the journal from the current lines and posts it, subject to the closed-period rules.
- **Reset to Draft** takes it back out of the accounts so it can be edited, then posted again. This is refused if the period is closed or a payment has been posted against the bill.

See Draft, Post & Reset to Draft.

Printing

Print on the bill produces an A4 document with your letterhead, the supplier and bill details, the lines, the totals and a signature strip for *Prepared by / Checked by / Approved by*. If the supplier is not VAT registered, the printed copy says so.

OPERATIONS · 26

Vendor Payments

Where: **Operations** ▸ **Vendor Payments**

Paying a bill

1. Select **New Payment**, or **Pay** / **Register Payment** on a posted vendor bill.
2. Choose the **Vendor Bill** being paid. Its outstanding balance is shown.
3. Enter the **Payment Number** and the **Payment Date**.
4. Enter the **Amount**. Part payments are allowed.
5. Choose the **Payment Method** and save.
6. Post the draft journal from **Operations** ▸ **Journal Inquiry**.

Account	Debit	Credit
`21100` Accounts Payable	Amount	—
`11100` Cash and Cash Equivalents	—	Amount

> **Only posted bills can be paid**
>
> The bill list shows posted bills with something left to pay. A draft bill is not offered, and if one is chosen another way the payment is refused with *"Bill … has not been posted yet"*. A draft has not been added to Accounts Payable, so there is nothing to pay off. Post the bill first.

When the payment is posted, the bill's *Amount Paid* rises and its status moves to **PartiallyPaid** or **Paid**. While a payment is posted against a bill, the bill itself cannot be reset to draft — reset the payment first.

OPERATIONS · 27

Petty Cash

Where: **Operations** ▸ **Petty Cash**

Petty cash is the small float kept on site to pay for minor items — cleaning supplies, a plumber's call-out, courier fees. Each float is its own asset account with its own running balance, so you always know how much cash should be in the box.

Setting up a float

1. In **System Setup** ▸ **Chart of Accounts**, create an **Asset** account for the float — for example `11150` Petty Cash – Marina Tower. Then **Edit** it and set **Petty Cash Float** to *Yes*.
2. Give it an **Opening Balance** if cash is already in the box on go-live, or fund it with a first replenishment.

Create one account per float if you keep cash at more than one site. Each appears in the float selector on this screen.

Recording an expense voucher

1. Choose the float at the top of the screen, then select **New Expense Voucher**.
2. Enter the **Voucher Date**, **Paid To** and a **Description** of what was bought.
3. Choose the **Expense Account** the cost belongs in.
4. Optionally choose the **Property** and **Unit**, so the cost appears against the right building in P&L by Property.
5. Enter the **Amount** and any **Reference Number** (the receipt number), then save.

Account	Debit	Credit
Expense account chosen on the voucher	Amount	—
The petty cash float account	—	Amount

Replenishing the float

When the box runs low, top it back up from the bank with **Replenish Float**: enter the date, choose the **Funding Account** (normally your bank or main cash account), the amount and a reference.

Account	Debit	Credit
The petty cash float account	Amount	—
Funding account — bank or main cash	—	Amount

> **Vouchers and replenishments are saved as drafts**
>
> They do not reduce the float balance until posted. Post them from **Operations** ▸ **Journal Inquiry** — see Draft, Post & Reset to Draft.

Counting the cash

The screen shows the float's opening balance, every voucher and replenishment in the date range, and the closing balance. Count the box and compare it with the closing balance. A shortfall means a voucher is missing or a slip was lost. **Print** gives a signed-off petty cash report.

> **Replenishing is not an expense**
>
> Moving cash from the bank into the box changes where the cash is, not how much the company has. The Statement of Cash Flows leaves these transfers out for that reason.

OPERATIONS · 28

Fixed Assets & Depreciation

Where: **Operations** ▸ **Fixed Assets**

The fixed asset register tracks long-lived items — lifts, generators, air-conditioning plant, vehicles, fit-out — from acquisition through capitalisation to monthly depreciation.

Creating an asset

1. Select **New Fixed Asset**.
2. Enter the **Asset Code** and **Name**.
3. Select the **Asset Account** and the **Accumulated Depreciation Account** (defaults `15200` and `15300`).
4. Enter the **Useful Life (months)** and the **Depreciation Start Date**.
5. For assets migrated from a previous system, enter the **Opening Cost** and **Opening Accumulated Depreciation**.
6. **Save**.

Acquisition costs

Open an asset and select **Acquisition** to accumulate the costs that make up its value — the supplier invoice, freight, installation, professional fees. Each entry posts:

Account	Debit	Credit
`15400` Fixed Asset Clearing (capitalisable) or the expense account (not capitalisable)	Amount	—
Offset account — `11100` Cash or `21100` Accounts Payable	—	Amount

Choosing a vendor with an Accounts Payable offset also raises the vendor bill automatically, so the payable appears in the vendor's sub-ledger.

Capitalisation

When the asset is complete and in use, capitalise it. The accumulated clearing balance moves to the asset account and the depreciation schedule is generated over the useful life:

Account	Debit	Credit
`15200` Fixed Assets	Capitalised cost	—
`15400` Fixed Asset Clearing	—	Capitalised cost

Running depreciation

1. Open **Depreciation** from the fixed asset screen.
2. Enter the **posting date** — normally the month end being closed.
3. Select **Post Depreciation**. Every scheduled instalment on or before that date is posted.

Account	Debit	Credit
`62100` Depreciation Expense	Monthly charge	—
`15300` Accumulated Depreciation	—	Monthly charge

> **Accumulated Depreciation presentation**
>
> In this chart of accounts, `15300` is classified as an asset and carries a credit balance, acting as a contra-asset. It therefore reduces Total Assets on the Balance Sheet, which is the correct presentation. Do not "correct" its sign.

OPERATIONS · 29

Manual Journals

Where: **Operations** ▸ **Manual Journals**

Manual journals cover what the automatic postings cannot: accruals, corrections, deposit refunds, bank charges, reclassifications, and opening entries that do not belong to a sub-ledger.

Creating a journal

1. Select **New Manual Journal**.
2. Enter the **Entry Date** — the accounting date, which is the date the reports will use.
3. Enter a clear **Description** explaining why the entry exists.
4. Enter the **Document Number** and **Reference Number** where relevant.
5. For each line: choose the **Account**, enter either a **Debit** or a **Credit** (never both), and add a line **Description**. Choose a **Unit** on lines that relate to a building, so they appear against the right property in P&L by Property.
6. Add lines until total debits equal total credits. The running totals are displayed as you type.
7. Select **Save as Draft**.
8. Post it from **Operations** ▸ **Journal Inquiry**. Until then it is not in any report — see Draft, Post & Reset to Draft.

> **The balance rule is absolute**
> The system will not save a journal whose debits do not equal its credits, and will not accept a journal with fewer than two lines. If you see *"Journal entry is not balanced"*, check for a line with an amount in both columns, or a typing error in one figure.

Common manual journals

Purpose	Entry
Refund a security deposit	Dr `21300` Tenant Security Deposits · Cr `11100` Cash
Bank charges	Dr `63100` Finance Costs · Cr `11100` Cash
Accrue an unbilled expense	Dr expense account · Cr `21100` Accounts Payable
Write off an irrecoverable receivable	Dr `61100` Administrative Expenses · Cr `11200` Accounts Receivable
Settle VAT with the authority	Dr `21400` VAT Payable · Cr `11300` VAT Recoverable and/or `11100` Cash
Pay a landlord their share	Dr `21500` Due to Landlords · Cr `11100` Cash
Owner takes money for personal use	Dr `34100` Owner's Current Account *with a withdrawal category* · Cr `11100` Cash — see Owner Withdrawals

Write the narration for someone else

Six months from now, an auditor will read the description without any of today's context. Write it so that it explains itself: "*Refund of security deposit, lease LSE-0042, tenant Al Noor Trading, cheque 100233*", not "*deposit refund*".

OPERATIONS · 30

Journal Inquiry

Where: **Operations** ▸ **Journal Inquiry**

Journal Inquiry is the audit trail and the place where drafts become postings. Every journal in the company — automatic or manual, draft or posted — is listed here with its entry number, date, description, source and value.

Finding journals

1. Set the **From** and **To** dates.
2. Optionally choose a **Source Type** to see only one kind of transaction.
3. Set **Posted Only** to **No** to include drafts, or **Yes** to see only what is in the accounts.
4. Select **Go**.

Every journal line carries the property, unit, tenant, lease, vendor and source document it came from, so any figure in a report can be traced back to the transaction that caused it.

Posting and resetting

Button	What it does
Post	Puts one draft into the accounts.
Post All Drafts (n)	Posts every draft matching the current filter. Each is posted separately; any that cannot be posted are listed with the reason, and the rest still go through.
Reset to Draft	Takes one posted entry back out of the accounts so its document can be corrected.
Period locked badge	Shown instead of the buttons when the entry's period is closed.

Read Draft, Post & Reset to Draft for which screens leave drafts and when a reset is refused.

> **A good end-of-day habit**
> Filter today's date with **Posted Only = No** and post what is waiting. Drafts left behind are the commonest reason a report looks short.

Source types

Source type	Created by
`CustomerInvoice`	Posting a customer invoice
`CustomerReceipt`	Saving a customer receipt
`PdcReceiptMemo` / `PdcClearance`	Receiving and clearing a PDC
`SecurityDeposit`	Saving a security deposit
`RevenueRecognitionSchedule`	Processing revenue recognition
`VendorBill` / `VendorPayment`	Posting a bill or saving a payment
`PettyCashExpense` / `PettyCashReplenishment`	Petty cash vouchers and top-ups
`FixedAsset…`	Acquisition, capitalisation, depreciation
`PrepaymentSchedule` / `PrepaymentRecognition`	Prepayment setup and amortisation
`ManualJournal`	A manual journal
`FiscalYearClosing`	Closing the fiscal year

OPERATIONS · 31

Tenant Requests

Where: **Operations** ▸ **Tenant Requests**

Everything tenants raise through the self-service portal lands here: maintenance calls, requests for more time to pay, contract renewal questions, complaints and anything else. You need the **Handle Tenant Requests** permission to see this screen.

The queue

The screen opens on the **Open** requests — the work still outstanding. The buttons across the top filter it: **New** (not yet acknowledged), **In progress**, **Closed** and **All**, each with a count. The **Type** filter narrows it further.

- Requests are listed **worst first**: Urgent, then High, then oldest first.
- The **Age** column turns red once a request is 7 days old.
- An amber badge marks a payment postponement that was agreed but not yet applied to the invoice.

Working a request

1. Select **Open** on the request. You see what the tenant asked, their contact details, the property, unit and contract, and the full conversation.
2. Under **Update**, set the status to **Acknowledged** so the tenant knows it has been seen. Adjust the **Priority** if the tenant's own rating was off, and choose who it is **Assigned to**.
3. Use the **Conversation** box to reply. The tenant sees your reply in their portal.
4. Move it to **In progress** when work starts.
5. When done, set **Resolved** and write the **Response to the tenant** — what was done. It is required, because the tenant reads it. Use **Declined** if you will not do it, again with the reason.
6. Set **Closed** once nothing further is expected.

> **Internal notes**
>
> Tick **Internal note** before posting a message to keep it among staff — for instance, a note about the tenant's payment history. Internal notes are shown with an amber background and are **never** sent to the portal. Anything not ticked is visible to the tenant.

Payment postponement requests

A tenant asking for more time names the invoice and the date they could pay by. Agreeing to it and actually moving the date are two separate, deliberate steps:

1. Decide, and set the request to **Resolved** with your response — for example "*Agreed, invoice INV-… may be paid by 20 November.*"

2. A button appears: **Apply new due date to INV-…**. Press it and confirm.

Only the invoice's **due date** changes. The amount owed, the VAT and the journal are untouched — giving more time to pay is not a credit note, so no figure in any financial report moves. The change is recorded in the conversation, the tenant sees it, and the button cannot be pressed twice.

What the tenant can and cannot do

- Raise a request and add messages to it until it is closed.
- Withdraw it, but only while it is *Submitted* or *Acknowledged* — once work is under way, it stays.
- They cannot change its status, priority or assignment, and cannot see internal notes.

Statuses

Status	Meaning
Submitted	New. Nobody has looked at it yet.
Acknowledged	Seen by staff. The tenant can still withdraw it.
In progress	Work has started.
Resolved	Done, with a response to the tenant.
Declined	Will not be done, with the reason.
Withdrawn	Cancelled by the tenant.
Closed	Finished. No more messages can be added.

> **Nobody is notified automatically**
> There are no emails yet. Check this queue daily, and remind tenants to look at the portal for your replies.

REPORTING · 32

Trial Balance

Where: **Reporting** ▸ **Trial Balance**

The Trial Balance lists every account with a balance as at a chosen date and proves that the ledger is internally consistent. It is the first report to run and the last one to check.

Running the report

1. Enter the **As Of Date**.
2. Select **Refresh**.

The report is **cumulative**: it includes every posted journal from the beginning of the ledger up to and including the as-of date, plus opening balances. That is the correct behaviour for a trial balance — it shows a position, not a movement. To see movement between two dates, use the **General Ledger** report (General Ledger & Tenant Statement), which shows opening balance, period debits, period credits and closing balance per account.

> **Posted journals only**
> Drafts are left out of this and every other report. If a figure is missing, look for a draft in Journal Inquiry.

Columns

Column	Meaning
Code / Account	The account, sorted by code.
Type	Asset, Liability, Equity, Revenue or Expense.
Debit	Shown when the account's net balance is on the debit side.
Credit	Shown when the account's net balance is on the credit side.

Each account appears once, with its net balance on one side only. Accounts with a nil balance are omitted.

> **Totals must be equal**
> Total Debit must equal Total Credit. Because the system refuses to post an unbalanced journal, any difference comes from opening balances, not from transactions. Go to **System Setup** ▸ **Opening Balances** and check the Net Imbalance card — the difference on the Trial Balance will match it exactly. Troubleshooting walks through the diagnosis.

REPORTING · 33

Profit & Loss

Where: **Reporting** ▸ **Profit & Loss**

The Profit & Loss reports performance **over a period**: revenue earned less expenses incurred between two dates.

Running the report

1. Enter the **As Of Date** — the end of the period you want.
2. Select **Refresh**. The report covers **1 January of that year to the as-of date**.

What it contains

Section	Contents
Revenue	Every revenue account with a movement in the period, shown as credits less debits. Includes rental revenue released by revenue recognition, management fees and other income.
Expenses	Every expense account with a movement, shown as debits less credits. Direct property costs, administrative costs, depreciation, finance costs.
Net Profit / Loss	Total revenue less total expenses. This is the figure the Balance Sheet shows as Current Year Profit / Loss.

Revenue appears only after recognition

Invoicing a tenant does not create revenue. If the Profit & Loss shows less rent than you expect, the usual reason is that revenue recognition has not been processed up to the report date. Run **System Setup** ▸ **Revenue Recognition** and refresh.

Non-calendar fiscal years

The report currently starts the period at 1 January of the as-of year. If your company's fiscal year starts in another month, the Profit & Loss period and the Balance Sheet's Current Year Profit / Loss will not agree. In that case, read the year-to-date result from the Balance Sheet, which follows the company's configured fiscal year start.

The **Profit & Loss by Property** report (Management Reports) does not have this limitation: it takes an explicit From and To date and defaults to the company's configured fiscal year. Use it when you need a period other than calendar year to date.

Analysing the result by property

This report presents the company as a whole. To see the same revenue and expenses broken down per property, use **Reporting** ▸ **P&L by Property** — see Management Reports.

REPORTING · 34

Balance Sheet

Where: **Reporting** ▸ **Balance Sheet**

The Balance Sheet reports financial position **at a single date**: what the company owns, what it owes, and the residual belonging to the owners.

Running the report

1. Enter the **As Of Date**.
2. Select **Refresh**.

Structure

Section	Contents
Assets	Cash, receivables, VAT recoverable, PDCs on hand, prepaid expenses, investment property, fixed assets net of accumulated depreciation.
Liabilities	Payables, advances from customers (deferred rent), security deposits held, VAT payable, amounts due to landlords, PDC contra.
Equity	Share Capital, Retained Earnings – Prior Years, any other equity accounts, and **Current Year Profit / Loss** computed from the fiscal-year-to-date Profit & Loss.

The balancing check

Total Assets must equal **Total Liabilities and Equity**. If they differ, the cause is almost always one of:

- **Unbalanced opening balances.** Check **System Setup** ▸ **Opening Balances**; the difference will match the Net Imbalance exactly.
- **An unclosed prior fiscal year.** Prior-year profit remains in revenue and expense accounts, which the Balance Sheet does not present. Close the year (Period & Year Closing).

> **Cross-check against the Trial Balance**
> Trial Balance total debit minus total credit equals Total Assets minus Total Liabilities and Equity. The two reports fail together and are fixed together — you never have to diagnose them separately.

REPORTING · 35

Statement of Cash Flows

Where: **Reporting** ▸ **Statement of Cash Flows**

The Statement of Cash Flows shows where cash came from and where it went over a period, prepared under **IAS 7** using the **direct method**. It answers the question the Profit & Loss cannot: the business made a profit, so why is there less cash?

Running the report

1. Enter the **From** and **To** dates. The default is the fiscal year to date.
2. Refresh. **Print** gives a clean copy.

How to read it

Four cards summarise the period: **Opening Cash**, **Operating** cash flow, **Net Movement** and **Closing Cash**. The statement below splits the movement three ways:

Section	What lands there
Operating	Rent collected, suppliers and expenses paid, VAT paid or refunded, deposits taken or returned — the day-to-day business.
Investing	Buying or selling long-term assets — property, fixed assets (accounts coded 15000 and above).
Financing	Capital put in by owners, owner drawings, loans — anything touching equity.

Each line is the account on the other side of the cash movement, with a **Movements** count of the journals behind it, so a surprising figure can be traced in Journal Inquiry.

The statement ends: net increase or decrease in cash + cash at the beginning = cash at the end.

What counts as cash

- **Included:** the account mapped as Default Cash, plus every petty cash float.
- **Excluded: PDC On Hand.** A post-dated cheque in the drawer has not been banked, so it is not a cash equivalent. It enters the statement when it clears.
- **Excluded: transfers between cash accounts.** Topping up petty cash from the bank moves cash between pockets; it is not a cash flow.

> **It always reconciles**
>
> Every movement is read from the ledger itself, so the closing figure always agrees with the cash accounts in the Trial Balance. If it ever does not, a red warning appears at the top with the difference. That would mean a journal shape the report did not expect — report it through **System Setup** ▸ **Send Feedback**.

Nothing appears?

If the report says no cash accounts are configured, set the **Default Cash** mapping in Account Mapping. Like every report, it includes posted journals only.

REPORTING · 36

General Ledger & Tenant Statement

Where: **Reporting** ▸ **General Ledger**

General Ledger

Reporting ▸ General Ledger

The General Ledger shows the detailed movement of a single account between two dates. This is the report to use when you need *activity for a period* rather than a position at a date.

1. Choose the **Account**.
2. Enter the **From Date** and **To Date**.
3. Select **Refresh**.

The report presents the **opening balance** at the from-date, then every journal line in the period with its date, entry number, description and debit or credit, with a **running balance**, and finally the **closing balance** and period totals.

> **Use this to explain any Trial Balance figure**
> If an account's Trial Balance figure looks wrong, run the General Ledger for that account across the full period. Every posting that produced the balance is listed, each traceable to its source document through Journal Inquiry.

Tenant Statement

Reporting ▸ Tenant Statement

A tenant-facing account showing everything charged to and received from one tenant.

1. Choose the **Tenant**.
2. Enter the date range.
3. Select **Refresh**, then print or save to PDF for the tenant.

The statement shows the tenant's opening balance, each invoice as a charge and each receipt or cleared PDC as a credit in date order with a running balance, then total charges, total payments and the closing balance owed.

REPORTING · 37

VAT Return

Where: **Reporting** ▸ **VAT Return**

The figures for your UAE VAT return for a tax period: VAT you charged tenants, VAT you can reclaim on costs, and the difference you owe. Use it to fill in the return on the FTA portal.

Running the report

1. Enter the tax period **From** and **To** dates. The default is the calendar quarter you are in, the usual period for a business of this size.
2. Refresh.

If no TRN is set, the report warns you first — see VAT Settings.

What it shows

Section	Contents
Output Tax Due	VAT charged on posted customer invoices in the period.
Input Tax Recoverable	VAT you can reclaim on posted vendor bills in the period.
Output Tax — Supplies Made	Invoices grouped by VAT treatment (standard, exempt, zero-rated): number of invoices, net amount, VAT.
Input Tax — Purchases	Bill lines grouped by attribution (taxable, exempt, residual): number of bills, net amount, VAT charged, recoverable and irrecoverable.
Recovery Rate	The actual recovery rate for the period — taxable supplies as a share of all supplies made — with the provisional rate from VAT Settings shown underneath for comparison.

Net VAT payable is Output Tax Due less Input Tax Recoverable. A negative figure is a refund due to you.

> **Only posted documents count**
> Draft invoices and draft bills are left out, because they are not in the accounts. Post everything for the period before you run the return. Bills from suppliers who are not VAT registered carry no VAT and do not appear in the input tax figures at all.

The annual apportionment wash-up

Residual input VAT is reclaimed during the year at the *provisional* recovery rate. At the end of the fiscal year the report compares that with the **actual recovery rate** — your taxable supplies as a share of all supplies for the year — and shows the difference:

- A **positive** figure is additional VAT you may reclaim.

- A **negative** figure is VAT reclaimed too generously that must be repaid.

This figure is **not posted automatically**. Enter it on the return for the first period after year end, and record it with a manual journal between `11300` VAT Recoverable and the expense account the residual costs were charged to. Then update the provisional rate in VAT Settings for the new year.

Settling with the FTA

When you pay the VAT due, post a manual journal: Dr `21400` VAT Payable for the output tax, Cr `11300` VAT Recoverable for the input tax, Cr `11100` Cash for the net amount paid.

REPORTING · 38

Tenant & Property Reports

Where: **Reporting** ▸ **Management — Tenants & Properties**

The three reports in this chapter answer management questions rather than accounting questions: *which property is making money*, *how hard is the portfolio working*, and *which tenants can we rely on*. They are listed under **Reporting** ▸ **Management** and require the **View Reports** permission.

Profit & Loss by Property

Reporting ▸ **P&L by Property**

This is the general ledger Profit & Loss analysed across the **property dimension** that every journal line already carries. Accounts run down the rows, properties across the columns, so you can read one property's result down a column or one account across the whole portfolio along a row.

1. Enter the **From Date** and **To Date**. The default is the current fiscal year to date, honouring the company's fiscal year start month.
2. Optionally choose a single **Property** to narrow the report to one column.
3. Select **Refresh**.

Each column shows total revenue, total expenses, net profit or loss and net margin percentage. The final column totals the row across all properties and reconciles to the general ledger Profit & Loss for the same dates.

> **The Unallocated column**
>
> A journal line only carries a property if the source transaction identified one. Invoices, receipts, PDCs, revenue recognition and security deposits always do, because they descend from a lease. Vendor bills do when a property is chosen on the bill. **Manual journals only do when a unit / cost centre is selected on the line** — the property is then derived from that unit.
>
> Anything without a property is collected into a highlighted **Unallocated** column so the report still reconciles to the GL. If that column is large, the fix is to reopen those manual journals and set the unit.

Revenue is presented as credits less debits and expenses as debits less credits, so a negative figure means a reversal or reclassification occurred in the period rather than an error.

Property Utilization

Reporting ▸ **Property Utilization**

A single-page view of how hard each property is working at a chosen date.

Measure	How it is calculated
Occupancy %	Units with status *Occupied* ÷ total units. Driven by unit status, which is set automatically when a lease becomes active.
Area utilization %	Area of units under a lease that is active and current at the as-of date ÷ total area. Measures let space rather than unit count, so one large vacant unit shows its true weight.
Standard annual rent	Sum of each unit's asking rent.
Contracted annual rent	Sum of the annual rent on leases active at the as-of date.
Rent realisation %	Contracted ÷ standard. Below 100% means vacancy or leases signed under the asking rent; above 100% means units are let above asking.
Rent gap	Standard less contracted — annualised revenue being forgone. The number to attack first.
Rent per sq ft	Contracted rent ÷ leased area. Compares pricing across properties of different sizes.
Expiring 90d	Active leases ending within 90 days of the as-of date — the renewal pipeline.

Summary cards at the top give the portfolio position, and a total row closes the table. Occupancy and area utilization each carry a colour bar: green at 85% and above, amber from 60%, red below.

> **Occupancy and area utilization can disagree — and that is useful**
>
> High unit occupancy with low area utilization means your small units are let and your large ones are empty. That single comparison usually points straight at where the revenue is being lost.

Tenant Health & Ranking

Reporting ▸ Tenant Health & Ranking

Every tenant scored from 0 to 100 and ranked best first, with the underlying figures shown alongside the score so the ranking can always be explained to the tenant or to management.

The four components

Component	Weight	Basis
Collection ratio	40%	Total collected ÷ total invoiced. The strongest single signal of a paying tenant. Collections include cleared PDCs, because clearance updates the invoice.
Overdue exposure	30%	Overdue balance ÷ total invoiced, inverted, then reduced by an ageing penalty of up to 30 points as the oldest overdue invoice passes 120 days.
PDC reliability	15%	Cleared cheque value ÷ (cleared + bounced) value.
Tenure & commitment	15%	Years occupied since the first lease start, capped at five years (70% of the component), plus current contract length capped at 36 months (30%).

Missing data never counts against a tenant

A component that cannot be measured — a tenant who has never issued a post-dated cheque, or one with no invoices yet — is dropped, and its weight is shared across the components that can be measured. Nobody is penalised for the absence of a behaviour rather than for the behaviour itself. A tenant with no measurable activity at all is shown as *No activity* and graded N/A.

Grades

Grade	Score	Reading
A	85 – 100	Pays in full and on time, long tenure. Prioritise renewal.
B	70 – 84	Reliable with minor slippage.
C	55 – 69	Watch list. Follow up before the next billing date.
D	40 – 54	Material arrears or a short, unproven relationship. Secure additional cover.
E	Below 40	Serious exposure. Check deposit cover and consider legal steps.

Columns worth knowing

- **Outstanding** includes the tenant's opening balance, so it agrees with the tenant statement.
- **Overdue** counts only posted invoices past their due date and not fully paid. Draft and cancelled invoices are excluded because they carry no ledger balance.
- **Oldest (days)** is the age of the earliest unpaid overdue invoice — often more telling than the amount.
- **Avg days to pay** is the average of receipt date less invoice due date. A negative figure means the tenant pays early.
- **PDC on hand** is cheque value held but not yet cleared — future cash, not yet collected.
- **Deposit held** is the security deposit still in *Held* status, i.e. your cover against the arrears in the same row.
- **Tenure (yrs)** runs from the tenant's earliest lease start date to the as-of date, across all their contracts.

PDC reliability needs a bounce workflow to discriminate

The PDC register supports a *Bounced* status, but no screen currently sets it — a cheque is either *Received* or *Cleared*. Until a bounce action exists, the PDC reliability component scores 100% for every tenant who has had a cheque clear, and therefore does not yet separate good payers from bad ones. The other three components carry the ranking in the meantime.

REPORTING · 39

Owner Reports

Where: **Reporting** ▸ **Management — Owners**

Two reports written for property owners: what is let to whom in their buildings, and what they have personally drawn from the business.

Owner Tenancy Schedule

Reporting ▸ Owner Tenancy Schedule

Who occupies each unit, on what terms and what they owe, grouped by property owner. It is the report to send an owner of a managed building, or to review your own portfolio unit by unit.

1. Enter the **As Of Date**.
2. Optionally narrow it to **Owned** or **Managed** property, or to one **Owner**.
3. Tick **Show vacant units** to list empty units too — useful for seeing what is available to let.
4. Refresh, then print for the owner.

Each row shows the property and unit, the tenant and their contact details, the contract and its term, the rent and VAT treatment, what is outstanding, and the contract status. The owner name comes from the property record.

Owner Withdrawals

Reporting ▸ Owner Withdrawals

Enter a **From** and **To** date — the default is the company's fiscal year to date. The report has three parts:

- **Owner Account Movement** — per owner account: opening balance, withdrawals and contributions in the period, and closing balance.
- **Breakdown by Category** — categories down the rows, owner accounts across the columns, with each category's share of total spend.
- **Detail** — every line posted to an owner account in the period, with its date, entry number, description and category.

Reading	Meaning
Credit closing balance	The business still owes the owner this amount.
Debit closing balance	The owner has drawn more than they put in and now owes the business.
Negative category amount	A refund of personal spend back into the business, posted against that category.
Uncategorised row	Movement with no category. Expected for capital introduced or a transfer of the owner's balance; investigate if it represents spending.

One posting, two truthful reports

The owner gets a full personal expenditure statement, and the company's Profit & Loss stays a true record of trading. Both come from the same posted journal, so there is no separate spreadsheet to reconcile. See Owner Withdrawals Explained.

TENANT SELF-SERVICE · 40

The Tenant Portal: Staff Guide

Where: **Master Data** ▸ **Tenants** ▸ **Portal**

The tenant portal is a separate, mobile-friendly site where each tenant sees their own account and sends you requests. Tenants cannot register themselves: you issue each one a login.

Giving a tenant access

1. Open **Master Data** ▸ **Tenants** and select **Portal** on the tenant's row.
2. Under **Issue Access**, check the **username**. The tenant's email is filled in when it is on file; it must be unique across all tenants.
3. Select **Issue portal access**.
4. A green box shows the **username** and a **temporary password**. Copy both now — the password is shown only once and cannot be looked up later, by anyone.
5. Send the tenant the address `https://realestatemanager.odehanas.com/portal/login` with their username and temporary password.

On first sign-in the tenant must choose their own password before going any further.

Managing an existing login

The **Current Status** panel shows the username, whether the account is active, whether the temporary password has been changed yet, the last sign-in, and any lock-out.

Situation	What to do
Tenant forgot the password	**Reset password** issues a new temporary password and the old one stops working.
Tenant is locked out	Too many wrong passwords lock the account for a while. Wait, or reset the password.
Tenancy has ended	**Suspend access** blocks sign-in immediately. The account and its history are kept, and **Re-enable access** restores it.

Only users with *Create & Edit Master Data* can issue or change portal logins.

What the tenant sees

Tab	Contents
Account	Balance due, overdue amount, cheques held, deposit held, and their tenancy.
Invoices	Every invoice with its total, paid and outstanding amounts; overdue ones highlighted.
Payments	Receipts, and their post-dated cheques with each one's status.
Statement	Their running account over a chosen date range.
Contracts	Their contracts, terms and expiry.
Requests	Requests they have raised, and the conversation with you.

> **Tenants see posted transactions only**
> Invoices, receipts, cheques and deposits appear in the portal once their journal is posted, so what a tenant sees always agrees with their balance. A receipt you have saved but not yet posted does not show — post receipts and cheques the same day so tenants see their payments promptly.

Send tenants the Guide for Tenants; it is also available to them from the portal.

> **A tenant only ever sees their own account**
> Every portal screen takes the tenant from their sign-in, never from the address bar, so changing a number in the URL cannot open another tenant's data. A tenant who tries to open a staff page is sent back to their portal.

> **Testing it yourself**
> Issue a login to a test tenant and sign in as them in a **private window** (Ctrl + Shift + N). In the same window as your staff session, each kind of sign-in would keep sending you back to its own side.

Requests that tenants raise are handled in Tenant Requests.

TENANT SELF-SERVICE · 41

Guide for Tenants

Where: **Tenant portal**

Welcome to your tenant portal. Here you can check your account at any time and send us requests, from your phone or computer.

Signing in

1. Open the portal address you were sent.
2. Enter the username and temporary password we gave you.
3. The first time, you will be asked to choose your own password. Keep it private.

If you forget your password, or enter it wrongly too many times, contact us and we will send you a new one.

Your account

Tab	What you will find
Account	How much is due, anything overdue, the cheques we are holding, your deposit, and your tenancy details.
Invoices	All your invoices and what is still outstanding on each. Overdue invoices are highlighted.
Payments	Payments we have received, and the cheques you have given us with their status.
Statement	Your full account for any dates you choose. You can print it.
Contracts	Your tenancy contracts, rent and dates, and when each one expires.
Requests	Things you have asked us for, and our replies.

A payment can take a little time to appear while we record it. If something looks wrong, send us a request.

Making a request

1. Open **Requests** and select **New request**.
2. Choose what you need:
   - **Maintenance / repair** — something needs fixing. Choose the kind of problem and, if you like, a preferred visit date.
   - **Request more time to pay** — choose the invoice and the date you could pay by.
   - **Contract renewal**, **Complaint** or **Other request**.
3. Give it a short title and describe it as fully as you can.
4. Choose how urgent it is. Please use **Urgent** only for something unsafe or causing damage right now, such as

a burst pipe or no electricity.

5. Select **Send request**. You will receive a reference number such as `REQ-2026-0001`.

Following your request

Open the request at any time to see its status and our messages, and to reply. Its status moves from **Submitted** to **Acknowledged** when we have seen it, to **In progress** when work starts, and to **Resolved** with our response when it is done.

You can **withdraw** a request until we start work on it.

> **About requests for more time to pay**
> A request is not an agreement. The amount you owe does not change, and your current due date still applies unless we confirm otherwise. If we agree, you will see *Agreed and applied* on the request and the new due date on the invoice.

> **Check back for replies**
> We do not send email notifications yet, so please sign in to see our replies.

REFERENCE · 42

Owner Withdrawals Explained

Money the owner takes out of the business for personal use is not a company expense. It is a **distribution** — a movement in equity. Putting it through the company's expense accounts would understate profit and misstate the Profit & Loss.

But the owner still wants to know what they spent it on. RealEstateManager solves this with a dedicated analysis dimension: the posting goes to a single equity account, and each line carries an **owner withdrawal category** that says what the money was for.

> **Why this is not a chart-of-accounts problem**
>
> Adding expense accounts for "school fees" or "personal travel" would put the owner's private life into the company's books and inflate its cost base. Adding them as unit cost centres would be worse still — cost centres in this system are *units*, used to allocate rental revenue and property costs to the space that generated them. Owner spending relates to no unit at all.
>
> A separate dimension keeps the chart of accounts clean, keeps cost centres meaningful, and still gives the owner a full breakdown.

The owner's current account

The standard chart seeds one equity account for this purpose:

Code	Account	Type
`34100`	Owner's Current Account	Equity, flagged as an owner account

Because it is equity, a **credit** balance means the business owes the owner, and a **withdrawal is a debit** that reduces that balance. Capital the owner puts in is a credit.

If you have more than one owner, add one account per owner — `34200`, `34300` and so on — under **System Setup ▸ Chart of Accounts**, setting **Owner Account** to *Yes* on each. The same category list serves all of them, and each gets its own column in the report. Only a postable Equity account can be flagged this way; the setting is ignored on any other type.

Posting owner expenditure

Operations ▸ Manual Journals ▸ New Manual Journal

The General Journal has an **Owner Withdrawal Category** column. It activates only on a line posted to an account flagged as an owner account; on every other line it stays locked and empty, and the row is highlighted when the dimension becomes available.

1. Enter the **Entry Date** and a clear **Description**.
2. On the first line choose the **owner's current account** and enter the amount as a **Debit**.

3. Choose the **Owner Withdrawal Category** — the column is now enabled on that line.
4. On the second line credit whatever the money came out of, normally `11100` Cash and Cash Equivalents.
5. Select **Save as Draft**, then post it from Journal Inquiry.

Owner pays school fees of 25,000 from the company bank account

Account	Category	Debit	Credit
`34100` Owner's Current Account	OW-30 Education	25,000.00	—
`11100` Cash and Cash Equivalents	—	—	25,000.00

No expense account is touched, so company profit is unaffected. The owner's equity balance falls by 25,000 and the spend is tagged as Education.

Owner introduces 100,000 of capital

Account	Category	Debit	Credit
`11100` Cash and Cash Equivalents	—	100,000.00	—
`34100` Owner's Current Account	leave blank	—	100,000.00

Leave the category blank on money coming *in*. Categories describe expenditure; a contribution is not expenditure.

> **The category is refused on any other account**
> If you try to save a category against an account that is not flagged as an owner account, the journal is rejected with a message naming the offending account. This is enforced on the server, not just hidden in the screen — it is what guarantees personal spending can never reach a company account by accident.

Clearing the balance at year end

The owner's current account carries forward like any equity account. If you want to clear it against retained earnings — for example when drawings are formally treated as a distribution of profit — post a manual journal debiting `32100` Retained Earnings – Prior Years and crediting `34100` Owner's Current Account. Leave the category blank: it is a transfer, not expenditure.

The categories themselves are maintained under Owner Withdrawal Categories, and the spending is reported in Owner Reports.

REFERENCE · 43

Chart of Accounts Reference

The standard chart created for every new company. Group accounts are shown in bold and cannot be posted to.

Code	Account	Type	Reporting group
10000	**Assets**	Asset	Assets
11100	Cash and Cash Equivalents	Asset	Assets
11200	Accounts Receivable (control)	Asset	Assets
11300	VAT Recoverable	Asset	Assets
11400	PDC On Hand	Asset	Assets
11500	Prepaid Expenses	Asset	Assets
15100	Investment Property	Asset	Assets
15200	Fixed Assets	Asset	Assets
15300	Accumulated Depreciation (contra)	Asset	Assets
15400	Fixed Asset Clearing	Asset	Assets
20000	**Liabilities**	Liability	Liabilities
21100	Accounts Payable (control)	Liability	Liabilities
21200	Advances from Customers (unearned revenue)	Liability	Liabilities
21300	Tenant Security Deposits	Liability	Liabilities
21400	VAT Payable	Liability	Liabilities
21500	Due to Landlords	Liability	Liabilities
21600	PDC Contra	Liability	Liabilities
30000	**Equity**	Equity	Equity
31100	Share Capital	Equity	Equity
32100	Retained Earnings – Prior Years	Equity	Equity
33100	Current Year Profit or Loss	Equity	Equity
34100	Owner's Current Account (owner account)	Equity	Equity
40000	**Revenue**	Revenue	Revenue
41100	Rental Revenue – Owned	Revenue	Revenue
42100	Management Fee Revenue	Revenue	Revenue
43100	Other Income	Revenue	Revenue
50000	**Direct Expenses**	Expense	DirectExpense
51100	Property Operating Expenses	Expense	DirectExpense
52100	Property Maintenance	Expense	DirectExpense
60000	**General Expenses**	Expense	GeneralExpense
61100	Administrative Expenses	Expense	GeneralExpense

Code	Account	Type	Reporting group
62100	Depreciation Expense	Expense	GeneralExpense
63100	Finance Costs	Expense	GeneralExpense

Accounts you add yourself

Code	Account	Purpose
e.g. 11150	Petty Cash – *site name*	One Asset account per petty cash float, with **Petty Cash Float** set to Yes. See Petty Cash.
34200…	Owner's Current Account – *owner name*	One Equity account per additional owner, with **Owner Account** set to Yes. See Owner Withdrawals Explained.
39999	Opening Balance Control Account	Equity. Absorbs any imbalance in opening balances. Should return to zero. See Opening Balances.

REFERENCE · 44

Accounting Entries Reference

Every journal the system posts automatically. All are generated with balanced debits and credits; the system rejects any entry that does not balance.

Transaction	Debit	Credit
Customer invoice owned property	11200 Accounts Receivable — total	21200 Advances from Customers — subtotal 21400 VAT Payable — VAT
Customer invoice managed property	11200 Accounts Receivable — total	21500 Due to Landlords — subtotal 21400 VAT Payable — VAT
Customer receipt	11100 Cash and Cash Equivalents	11200 Accounts Receivable
PDC received memorandum	11400 PDC On Hand	21600 PDC Contra
PDC cleared receivable mode	21600 PDC Contra (reversal) 11100 Cash and Cash Equivalents	11400 PDC On Hand (reversal) 11200 Accounts Receivable
PDC cleared advance mode	21600 PDC Contra (reversal) 11100 Cash and Cash Equivalents	11400 PDC On Hand (reversal) 21200 Advances from Customers
Security deposit	11100 Cash and Cash Equivalents	21300 Tenant Security Deposits
Revenue recognition owned property	21200 Advances from Customers	41100 Rental Revenue – Owned
Revenue recognition managed property	21500 Due to Landlords	42100 Management Fee Revenue
Vendor bill one debit per line	Each line's account — line net + any irrecoverable VAT 11300 VAT Recoverable — recoverable VAT	21100 Accounts Payable — total
Vendor payment	21100 Accounts Payable	11100 Cash and Cash Equivalents
Petty cash voucher	Expense account on the voucher	The petty cash float account
Petty cash replenishment	The petty cash float account	Funding account — bank or main cash
Fixed asset acquisition cost	15400 Fixed Asset Clearing (capitalisable) or expense account (not capitalisable)	11100 Cash or 21100 Accounts Payable
Fixed asset capitalisation	15200 Fixed Assets	15400 Fixed Asset Clearing
Depreciation	62100 Depreciation Expense	15300 Accumulated Depreciation
Prepayment setup	11500 Prepaid Expenses	11100 Cash or 21100 Accounts Payable
Prepayment amortisation	Expense account on the schedule	11500 Prepaid Expenses
Fiscal year closing	Each revenue account — its balance 32100 Retained Earnings — if a net loss	Each expense account — its balance 32100 Retained Earnings — if a net profit

Every entry above except fixed asset postings is created as a draft (customer invoices and vendor bills are posted in the same click). See Draft, Post & Reset to Draft.

Status Values Reference

Record	Status	Meaning
Unit	Vacant	Available to lease.
	Occupied	Under an active lease. Set automatically.
	UnderMaintenance	Temporarily out of service.
	Reserved	Held for a prospective tenant.
Lease	Draft	Being prepared.
	Active	In force. Set on creation.
	Terminated	Ended early.
	Expired	Ran to its end date.
	Renewed	Replaced by a successor contract.
Customer invoice	Draft	Generated, not posted. No ledger impact.
	Posted	Journal written; fully outstanding.
	PartiallyPaid	Part settled.
	Paid	Fully settled.
	Cancelled	Voided.
PDC receipt	Draft	Transient state during creation.
	Received	In custody; memorandum posted.
	Cleared	Honoured by the bank; cash recorded.
Vendor bill	Draft	Entered, not posted.
	Posted	Journal written; payable outstanding.
	PartiallyPaid	Part settled.
	Paid	Fully settled.
Revenue recognition	Planned	Scheduled, not yet posted.
	Posted	Journal written; revenue earned.
Prepayment schedule	Active	Instalments still to release.
	Completed	Fully amortised.
Journal entry	Draft	Saved, not in any report. Can be posted.
	Posted	In the accounts. Can be reset to draft unless locked or depended on.
	Period locked	Shown when the entry's period is closed. Cannot be posted or reset.

Record	Status	Meaning
Tenant request	Submitted	New; not yet seen.
	Acknowledged	Seen by staff. Tenant can still withdraw.
	InProgress	Work started.
	Resolved	Done, with a response to the tenant.
	Rejected	Shown as *Declined*; will not be done, with the reason.
	Cancelled	Shown as *Withdrawn*; cancelled by the tenant.
	Closed	Finished; no more messages.
Tenant portal login	Active	Can sign in.
	Suspended	Sign-in blocked; account and history kept.
Accounting period	Open	Accepts postings.
	Closed	Locked; figures are final.

REFERENCE · 46

Troubleshooting

A transaction I saved is missing from a report

It is almost certainly still a **draft**. Receipts, PDCs, deposits, payments, petty cash, manual journals, revenue recognition and prepayments all save drafts.

1. Open **Operations** ▸ **Journal Inquiry**.
2. Set **Posted Only** to **No**, set the dates and select **Go**.
3. Post the entry, or use **Post All Drafts**.

See Draft, Post & Reset to Draft.

"Reset to Draft" is greyed out or refused

Either the period is closed, or something depends on the entry — a receipt against the invoice, a payment against the bill, a posted PDC clearance. Reset the later transaction first, or post a correcting journal in an open period.

I cannot see the Add or Edit buttons on master data

Your account has *View Master Data* only. Ask the master data owner, or an administrator to change your permissions — see Master Data rules.

"...is already registered to..." when saving a tenant or vendor

The trade licence, ID, passport or TRN you entered belongs to an existing record, which the message names. Open that record instead of creating a duplicate. If it is genuinely a different party, check the number was typed correctly.

A vendor bill will not let me enter VAT

The supplier is not marked **VAT registered**, or has no TRN on file. Correct the vendor record if they are in fact registered — see Vendors. A bill already saved keeps the treatment it was saved with.

The Trial Balance does not balance

Because the system rejects any unbalanced journal, transactions cannot cause this. The cause is opening balances.

1. Open **System Setup** ▸ **Opening Balances**.
2. Read the **Net Imbalance (Dr − Cr)** card. It will equal the Trial Balance difference exactly.
3. Identify the missing side. Debits exceeding credits means a credit-side opening balance is missing — almost always equity.

4. Open **System Setup** ▸ **Chart of Accounts**, edit `31100` Share Capital or `32100` Retained Earnings – Prior Years, and enter the balancing figure.
5. Return to Opening Balances and confirm the green **Balanced** badge, then re-run the Trial Balance.

> **Worked diagnosis**
> Trial Balance shows debits 375,000 and credits 175,000 — a difference of 200,000. The credit side contains only transaction balances, and Share Capital and Retained Earnings are both nil. The conclusion is that 200,000 of asset opening balances were entered with no matching equity opening balance. Entering 200,000 on `31100` or `32100` balances both the Trial Balance and the Balance Sheet.

The Balance Sheet does not balance

- Check opening balances as in D.1 — the same difference appears in both reports.
- Check that every prior fiscal year has been closed. Unclosed prior-year profit sits in revenue and expense accounts, which the Balance Sheet does not present.

Revenue is missing from the Profit & Loss

- Run **System Setup** ▸ **Revenue Recognition** up to the report date. Invoicing alone does not create revenue.
- Confirm the invoices themselves are **Posted**, not still in Draft.
- For a managed property, remember only the commission is revenue — the rent belongs to the landlord.

A transaction will not post

Message	Cause and fix
"Journal entry is not balanced."	A manual journal line has an amount in both the debit and credit columns, or the totals differ. Correct the line.
"A journal entry must contain at least two lines."	Add the counterpart line.
"Account mapping for … is not configured."	Open **System Setup** ▸ **Account Mapping** and select a valid, active account for that mapping.
"Contract number already exists."	Contract numbers are unique per company. Use a different one.
"This unit already has an overlapping active lease."	Terminate or adjust the existing lease first.
"Cheque number already exists."	Cheque numbers are unique per company. Check whether the PDC was already logged.
"PDC amount cannot exceed the outstanding invoice balance."	Reduce the amount, or split the cheque across invoices.
"Billing frequency must be 1, 2, 3, 4, 6, or 12."	Billing frequency must divide 12 exactly.

A menu is not visible

- Confirm the permission with your administrator (Companies, Users & Permissions).
- Check that the company's subscription has not expired — expiry withdraws the processing menus.
- Confirm you are in the right company using the company selector.

A tenant's balance looks wrong

1. Run **Reporting** ▸ **Tenant Statement** for the tenant across the full period.
2. Check for invoices still in Draft — they are not in the ledger.
3. Check for PDCs still in Received status — the cash has not arrived yet.
4. Check for a security deposit wrongly entered as a customer receipt.
5. Confirm the tenant's opening balance was entered on the tenant record, not on the AR account.

Glossary

Term	Meaning
Accrual basis	Recording income when it is earned and expenses when they are incurred, regardless of when cash moves. The basis this system uses.
Advances from Customers	Account `21200`. Rent billed but not yet earned. A liability, released to revenue month by month.
Control account	A GL account whose balance is the total of a sub-ledger — Accounts Receivable over tenants, Accounts Payable over vendors.
Double entry	Every transaction affects at least two accounts with equal debits and credits, so the ledger is always self-proving.
Due to Landlords	Account `21500`. Rent collected on a managed property that belongs to its owner.
Fiscal year	The company's twelve-month reporting year, starting in the configured fiscal year start month.
Managed property	A property you administer for a third-party owner. Only your commission is revenue.
Natural balance	The side an account normally sits on: debit for assets and expenses, credit for liabilities, equity and revenue.
Opening balance	A balance brought forward from a previous system at go-live.
Owned property	A property you own. The rent is your revenue.
PDC	Post-dated cheque — a cheque held today, payable on a future date.
Posting	Writing a document's journal into the general ledger. Before posting, a document has no accounting effect.
Revenue recognition	Releasing billed rent into revenue as the occupancy is provided, one month at a time.
Sub-ledger	A detailed register behind a control account — the tenant register, the vendor register, the fixed asset register.
Trial balance	A listing of every account balance at a date, proving total debits equal total credits.
Unearned revenue	See Advances from Customers.
Accounting date	On a vendor bill, the date its journal is booked to, which decides the period. Usually the bill date; later when the bill arrives after its month has closed.
Commercial invoice	A supplier invoice that carries no VAT, because the supplier is not VAT registered. The whole amount is a cost.
Draft	A journal that has been saved but not posted. It has no effect on any report until posted.
Input tax attribution	How a cost relates to your supplies — Taxable, Exempt or Residual — which decides how much of its VAT you can reclaim.
Internal note	A message on a tenant request that only staff can see.
Petty cash float	A small sum of cash kept on site, held in its own asset account.

Term	Meaning
Post	Put a draft journal into the accounts, so the reports include it.
Reset to Draft	Take a posted journal back out of the accounts so its document can be corrected.
Tax invoice	An invoice that charges VAT and meets UAE requirements. *Full* when the customer has a TRN, *simplified* when not.
Tenant portal	The separate site where tenants see their own account and send requests.
TRN	Tax Registration Number, issued by the Federal Tax Authority to a VAT-registered business.
Wash-up	The year-end correction of input VAT reclaimed on shared costs, from the provisional rate to the rate actually earned.

RealEstateManager — User Manual
End of document. To print or save: **Ctrl + P** → **Save as PDF** → paper size **A4**.